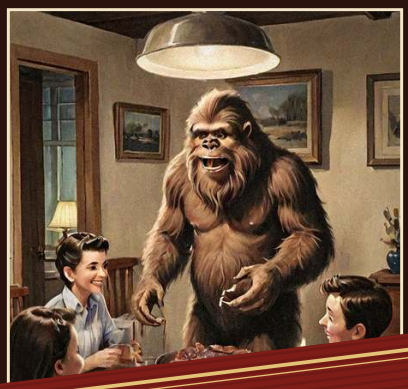














How to Raise a Well-Behaved Bigfoot

A FIRM HAND, A KIND HEART AND A VERY BIG BRUSH

BIGFOOT
60
SKILLS

HOW TO RAISE A WELL-BEHAVED BIGFOOT



EX LIBRIS

This book belongs to

_____
__

and their household, _____

How to Raise a Well-Behaved

BIGFOOT

60 Wholesome Skills for the Family Who Found a Sasquatch in the Woodshed

AN ILLUSTRATED HANDBOOK OF GOOD MANNERS FOR THE VERY LARGE AND VERY HAIRY

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION · 2026

How to Raise a Well-Behaved Bigfoot: 60 Wholesome Skills for the Family Who Found a Sasquatch in the Woodshed. Fun Books Home Edition, 2026.

Written and illustrated as an original work. The text and pictures in this book were created from scratch for this edition and are not copied from any other publication.

Please read before using this book. This is a work of good-natured humor. Every family, ranger, barber, photographer and Bigfoot in it is made up. Real wild animals should never be fed, invited indoors or hosed down in the yard, and real encounters in the woods call for the advice of your local forest ranger, not this book. Please do not follow footprints into the woods after dark. Do try the pancakes.

Printing tips. This book is laid out on US Letter (8.5 x 11 in) pages. Print double-sided, “flip on long edge”, at 100% scale. For a book that lies flat on the kitchen table, ask a copy shop for spiral or comb binding with a clear front and a heavy back cover.

Made with care for everyone who ever set an extra place at the table for someone a little different.

For every family who found someone unexpected
in the woodshed, and let him stay.

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INTRODUCTION

How to use this book

There was a time, not so long ago, when the biggest thing a family had to raise was a beagle. Then, one November morning, a line of footprints twenty inches long came out of the pine woods and stopped at our woodshed door. Inside was Woodrow: eight feet two, very hairy, very hungry and with no manners whatsoever.

Most families are not ready. Nobody teaches Bigfoot upbringing at school. The old etiquette books say nothing about doorways, bath day with the garden hose or what to do when your houseguest howls at the moon at a quarter past nine. This book is here to help.

What you'll find inside. Sixty skills in nine chapters, each on a single page laid out the same way: a picture for every step, a short explanation of why it matters, a materials panel with what you'll need, and a notes panel with tips and the most important warnings. Colored tabs on the edge of every page tell you which chapter you're in, so you can find the right page quickly, even during shedding season.

How to use it. Don't wait for the footprints. Read the first chapter tonight. Buy a second doormat. Find the biggest mixing bowl in the house and put it somewhere he can reach. Each skill you practice now is one less broken door frame later.

Start with the basics. If your Bigfoot has already arrived, begin with Chapter 1 (the first week), the house rules in Chapter 2, table manners in Chapter 3 and grooming in Chapter 4. Those four alone will put your household well ahead of the Hendersons, who are still pretending their Bigfoot is a large dog.

The appendix at the back gathers the charts and checklists you'll reach for most: a field guide to the people you will meet, a feeding chart, household remedies for Bigfoot mishaps, handy conversions, checklists, a household card, a glossary, and a log for the skills your household has mastered.

A word on kindness. A Bigfoot is very large, very strong and very easily hurt in his feelings. Watch for the boxes marked **Important**, and remember that the best-behaved Bigfoot in the world is simply one who knows he is part of the family.

CHAPTERS AT A GLANCE

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1. Found in the Woodshed	Footprints, first pancakes and a proper introduction	7
2. House Rules for a Big Fellow	Doorways, doormats and no howling after nine	7
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9. A Good Citizen of the Forest	Thank-you notes, the county fair and goodnight under the stars	6

CHAPTER ONE

1

FOUND IN THE WOODSHED

Footprints, first pancakes and a proper introduction







It started with the footprints. They came out of the pine woods behind the house, crossed the lawn in the first snow of November and stopped at the woodshed door. Each one was twenty inches long. Father said it was probably the Hendersons' dog. Then the woodshed door opened, and something eight feet tall and very hairy looked out at us and sneezed. That was how we met Woodrow. This chapter covers the first week: finding him, feeding him and making him feel welcome.

IN THIS CHAPTER

01 Reading Footprints in the Snow
02 Leaving Out a Plate of Pancakes
03 Making a Proper Introduction
04 Choosing a Good Name
05 Fixing Up the Woodshed as a Bedroom
06 Explaining Things to the Neighbors
07 Dealing With the Forest Ranger

HOW TO

READING FOOTPRINTS IN THE SNOW

SKILL 01 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 20 MINUTES · EASY

Every family that finds a Bigfoot finds the footprints first. They are large, bare and far apart, and they always lead somewhere you would rather not go before breakfast. Read them calmly. A footprint is just a letter of introduction that has not been opened yet.

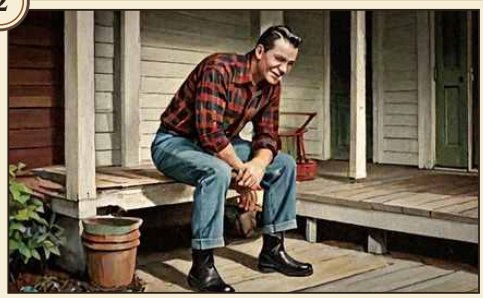
1



Notice the Tracks

Look out of the kitchen window before you put the kettle on. Big bare footprints in the snow are hard to miss.

2



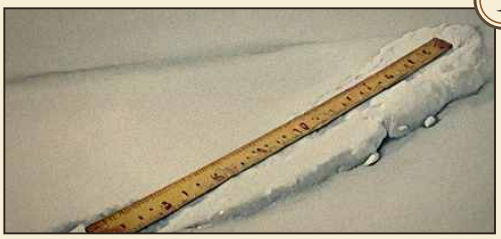
Put On Your Galoshes

Never investigate in your slippers. Mother has only just washed them.

3

Measure One

Lay the yardstick beside a print. Twenty inches means a Bigfoot. Twenty-one means a big Bigfoot.



4



Count the Toes

Five toes, all very large. If there are more than five, call the Ranger.

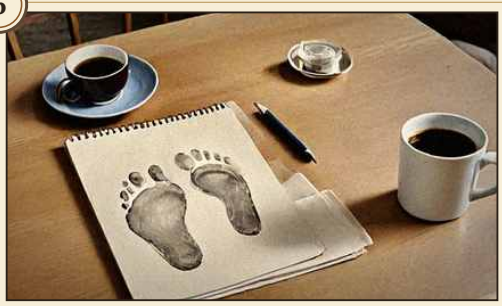
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Follow Them Slowly

Walk beside the prints, not in them. Bigfoot is shy, and so are most fathers.

6



Write Down What You Saw

Note the date, the size and the direction. Then go in and have breakfast. It will keep.

NOTES

A footprint is easier to measure in snow than in mud. If your Bigfoot arrives in spring, lay down a sheet of flour on the path.

IMPORTANT

Do not follow footprints into the woods after dark. Bigfoot can see in the dark and you cannot, and he will laugh.

MATERIALS

- A flashlight



- A yardstick



- Galoshes



- A thermos of coffee



- A pencil and notepad



HOW TO

LEAVING OUT A PLATE OF PANCAKES

SKILL 02 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 30 MINUTES · EASY

Nobody, not even a Bigfoot, can stay suspicious of a family that leaves out a warm stack of pancakes. It is the oldest welcome in the book. Use plenty of butter, real maple syrup and a big plate. A very big plate.

MATERIALS


A griddle


Pancake batter


Butter and maple syrup


A big serving platter


A dish towel

1



Mix a Double Batch

Then double it again. You are cooking for someone with feet twenty inches long.

2



Cook Them Golden

Medium heat. Flip when the bubbles pop. Stack them high.

3



Butter and Syrup

A pat of butter on top and syrup down the sides. Presentation matters, even in the woods.



6 *Collect the Clean Plate*

In the morning the plate will be licked clean. That is a thank-you note.

4



Set It on the Stump

The chopping stump by the woodshed is the right height and easy to find.

5



Wait Inside

Watch from the kitchen window with the curtains open a crack. Do not tap on the glass.

NOTES

Bigfoot prefers buttermilk pancakes. Blueberries in the batter will get you a second visit.

IMPORTANT

Do not use the good china. The plate may come back, but it may also come back with tooth marks.

HOW TO

MAKING A PROPER INTRODUCTION

SKILL 03 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

When you finally meet your Bigfoot face to face, remember that first impressions count on both sides. He has never met a family before, and you have never met anyone eight feet tall who smells of pine needles. Be polite, be slow and keep your hands where he can see them.

1



Stand Up Straight

Shoulders back, chin up. You represent the whole household.

2



Tip Your Hat

A slow tip of the hat says 'I mean no harm' in any language.

3

Say Your Name

Clearly, and only once. Bigfoot does not like a fuss.



4



Offer the Cookies

Set the plate on the fence post and step back. Let him come to you.

5



Shake Hands Gently

His hand is the size of a dinner platter. Let him do the squeezing, and keep it short.

6



Invite Him In for Coffee

If he sneezes, that means yes.

NOTES

Bigfoot bows by lowering his whole head. If he bows to you, bow back. It is a great honor.

IMPORTANT

Do not offer to shake hands while holding a cup of coffee. You will need a new shirt.

MATERIALS

- Your Sunday hat



- A clean handkerchief



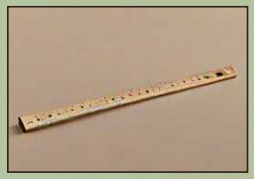
- A plate of cookies



- A calm voice



- Good posture



HOW TO

CHOOSING A GOOD NAME

SKILL 04 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 1 EVENING · EASY

A Bigfoot without a name is just a rumor. Give him a good, solid name, the kind a fellow can grow into. Our family took a vote at supper. The children wanted 'Fluffy'. Grandfather wanted 'General'. We settled on Woodrow, because we found him in the woodshed.

MATERIALS

- A hat for the names
- Slips of paper
- Pencils
- A bowl of popcorn
- Everyone at the table

1



Gather the Family

Everyone gets a vote, even Grandfather, even though he will vote for 'General'.

2



Write Down Ideas

One name per slip. No rude names. No names of former presidents.

3



Drop Them in a Hat

Father's good hat. He will pretend to mind.

4



Read Them Out Loud

Watch his face. He will show you which one he likes.

5



Try It Out

Call him by it across the yard. If he comes, it is the right name.



6 *Make It Official*

Paint it over the woodshed door. Now he lives here.

NOTES

Short names carry better across the woods. Two syllables are ideal. 'Woodrow' worked fine, 'Fluffy' did not.

IMPORTANT

Do not let the children name him after the mailman. The mailman will find out.

HOW TO

FIXING UP THE WOODSHED AS A BEDROOM

SKILL 05 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 1 WEEKEND · MEDIUM

Woodrow does not like the house at night. It is too warm, the ceilings are too low and the refrigerator hums at him. The woodshed suits him perfectly, with a few improvements. Treat it like a guest room for a very large, very hairy uncle.

1



Move the Firewood Out

Stack it neatly along the fence. He will help carry, if asked nicely.

2



Sweep It Clean

Cobwebs, sawdust and the old croquet set all go.

3

Make a Straw Bed

Four bales side by side, two quilts on top. He likes it lumpy.



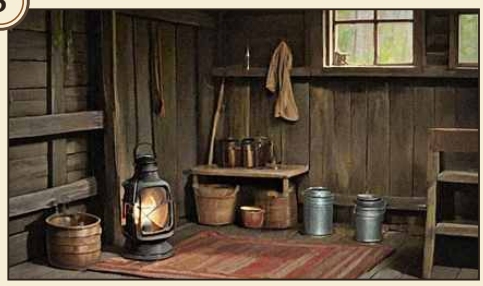
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Raise the Doorway

Saw a foot off the top of the door frame. Every morning bump is one less.

5



Add a Few Comforts

A lantern, a rug and a picture of a nice forest on the wall.

6



Show Him His Room

Open the door wide and step back. Let him find his own favorite corner.

NOTES

Bigfoot likes the smell of cedar. A few cedar shavings under the quilts make the room feel like home.

IMPORTANT

Never use a kerosene lantern near the straw. Hang it high on a nail and blow it out at bedtime.

MATERIALS

- Straw bales



- Three old quilts



- A hammer and nails



- A kerosene lantern



- A braided rug



HOW TO

EXPLAINING THINGS TO THE NEIGHBORS

SKILL 06 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 1 AFTERNOON · HARD

Sooner or later Mrs. Pruitt next door will look over the fence and see an eight-foot hairy fellow hanging out the wash. Better she hears it from you first, with a coffee cake and a calm explanation. A good neighbor can keep a secret. Mrs. Pruitt cannot, so plan for that.

MATERIALS


A coffee cake

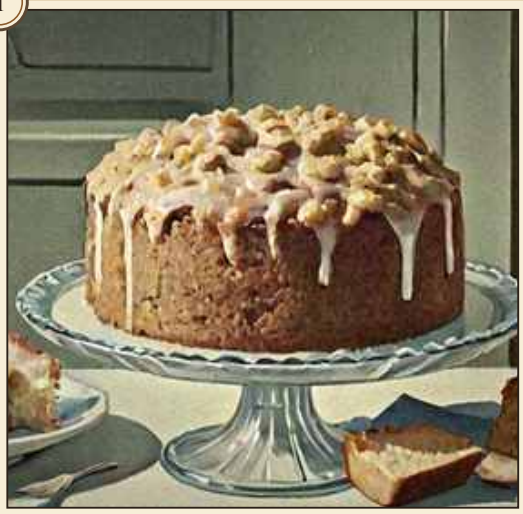

A pot of coffee


Your best smile


A photograph of Woodrow


Your Sunday gloves

1



Bake a Coffee Cake

Cinnamon and crumb topping. It softens any surprise.

2



Invite Her Over

Tuesday, eleven o'clock, after her soap opera.

3



Pour the Coffee

Sit her facing away from the window, for now.

4



Set Out the Good Cups

Lace doily, best china. Let her settle in before you say a word.

5



Let Her Look Out of the Window

He will be hanging out the sheets. It is the least frightening thing he does.



6 ### *Agree on a Story*

If anyone asks, he is Father's cousin from Oregon. He has a condition.

NOTES

Give the neighbors a job. Mrs. Pruitt now knits Woodrow's winter scarves and tells everyone they are for a tall nephew.

IMPORTANT

Do not introduce him to the neighbors' dog until you have introduced him to the neighbors. The dog will tell everyone.

HOW TO

DEALING WITH THE FOREST RANGER

SKILL 07 · FOUND IN THE WOODSHED · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Ranger Dobbs comes by every spring to talk about fire safety. This year he stayed for supper, because Woodrow answered the door. A forest ranger is a friend of the forest, and Bigfoot is part of the forest. Treat him as an ally and feed him well.

1



Greet Him at the Gate

Get there before Woodrow does. It will save explaining.

2



Walk Him Round the Back

Talk about the weather and the fire danger on the way.

3

Make the Introduction

Ranger, Woodrow. Woodrow, Ranger. Then stand back.



4



Offer Doughnuts to Both

No one has ever arrested anyone with powdered sugar on his chin.

5



Listen to the Ranger

He knows where the berries grow and where the hunters walk. Take notes.

6



Shake on a Deal

He will not tell, and Woodrow will help with the fire lookout tower. Everyone wins.

NOTES

Rangers are fond of pie. A rhubarb pie in the spring keeps a forest ranger on your side all year.

IMPORTANT

Do not let Woodrow try on the Ranger's hat. It will not fit, and the Ranger will never get it back.

MATERIALS

- A fresh pot of coffee



- A plate of doughnuts



- Your fire-safety pamphlet



- A firm handshake



- A clean shirt



CHAPTER TWO

2

HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW

Doorways, doormats and no howling after nine







A Bigfoot in the house is like a grand piano in the house: wonderful, but everything has to be moved around it. The first week, Woodrow broke two door frames, one armchair and the porch swing, and he howled at the moon every night at a quarter past nine. Every good household runs on rules, kindly made and firmly kept. Here are ours.

IN THIS CHAPTER

08 Ducking Through Doorways
09 Wiping His Feet (All Twenty Inches)
10 Sitting on Furniture That Will Hold Him
11 Keeping Him Off the Roof
12 Using His Indoor Voice
13 Keeping Him Out of the Icebox
14 Bedtime and the Big Blanket

HOW TO

DUCKING THROUGH DOORWAYS

SKILL 08 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 1 WEEK OF PRACTICE · EASY

An ordinary door is six feet eight inches tall. Woodrow is eight feet two. You can see the problem. Until he learns to duck, every doorway in the house will have a fresh dent in it, and so will he.

1



Measure the Doors

Write each height on a slip of masking tape stuck to the frame.

2



Pad the Top

Tape a cushion to the top of the kitchen door while he learns.

3



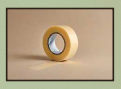
Show Him How

Bend at the knees and the waist, like going under a clothesline.

MATERIALS


A tape measure


A soft cushion


Masking tape


A cookie for rewards


A first-aid kit

4



Practice on the Back Door

Ten times in, ten times out. Clap each time.

5



Reward Every Good Duck

One cookie per duck. Count the cookies.

NOTES

A little bell hung from each door frame gives him a gentle warning. He will learn to duck when he hears it.

IMPORTANT

Never take the cushion down before the habit sticks. One bad bump and he will sulk in the woodshed for a day.



6 ### *Kiss the Bumps Better*

He will still bump once in a while. Be kind about it.

WIPING HIS FEET (ALL TWENTY INCHES)

SKILL 09 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 5 MINUTES, EVERY TIME · EASY

A Bigfoot walks barefoot through mud, snow, pine needles and the Hendersons' compost heap. Then he walks across your clean kitchen floor. The doormat is your first line of defense, and it needs to be a very big doormat.

MATERIALS

- Two large doormats



- A boot scraper



- A bucket of warm water



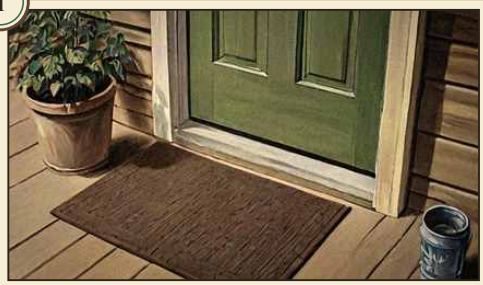
- An old towel



- A scrub brush



1



Lay Two Doormats

Side by side. One is not enough. One is a handkerchief to him.

2



Add a Boot Scraper

Bolt it to the top step for the worst of the mud.

3

Show Him How to Wipe

Left, right, left, right, like a march. Say it out loud.



4



Let Him Try

He will wipe very carefully the first time and very quickly every time after.

5



Rinse the Big Ones

On muddy days, a bucket of warm water and a towel at the door.

6



Check the Floor

Look behind him. Then look again. Then fetch the mop.

NOTES

Scatter a little sawdust on the porch in wet weather. It soaks up the mud before he even reaches the mat.

IMPORTANT

Do not mop around him while he is standing still. He will think it is a game, and he will win.

HOW TO

SITTING ON FURNITURE THAT WILL HOLD HIM

SKILL 10 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Woodrow weighs about as much as a small piano. Most living-room furniture was designed for a man who weighs about as much as a large dog. He has already flattened the porch swing and one armchair. Give him a seat of his own and teach him that it is his.

1



Inspect the Chairs

Rock each chair with your hand. If it creaks, it is not for him.

2



Build a Bigfoot Bench

Thick oak, heavy bolts. Build it like a bridge.

3



Add the Cushions

Big, soft and plaid. He likes plaid.

MATERIALS


A sturdy oak bench


Heavy bolts


Two big cushions


An old armchair (for practice)


A tape measure

4



Show Him His Seat

Pat it twice and say 'Woodrow's chair'. Pat it twice every time.

5



Steer Him Off the Sofa

Gently. With a cookie. Never with a broom.

NOTES

Put a lamp and a stack of picture magazines beside his bench. He likes to look at the pictures of trees.

IMPORTANT

Never let him sit in Grandfather's recliner. Grandfather will not speak to anyone for a week.



6 *Mend What Broke*

Glue, clamps and patience. The armchair will never be quite the same.

HOW TO

KEEPING HIM OFF THE ROOF

SKILL 11 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 1 WEEK · HARD

MATERIALS

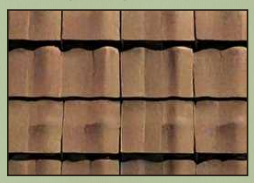
- A tall stepladder



- A tree for climbing



- Roofing shingles



- A bag of apples

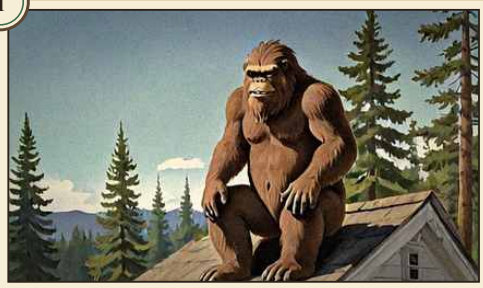


- A loud whistle



Bigfoot likes high places. From the top of the house he can see the woods, the lake and the Hendersons' television through their window. Unfortunately, roofs are not built for him, and every time he climbs up, it rains in the hall closet.

1



Find Out Why

Usually it is the view. Sometimes it is the cat.

2



Call Him Down Nicely

A bag of apples at the bottom of the ladder works better than shouting.

3

Give Him a Better Spot

A big oak tree at the edge of the yard has a better view and no shingles.



4



Practice 'Down, Please'

Say it kindly and point. Reward him at the bottom.

5



Fix the Shingles

Father, with Mother holding the ladder and offering advice.

6



Check the Hall Closet

Put a bucket under the drip until Father is done.

NOTES

Build him a platform in the oak tree. He will sit up there at sunset like a lighthouse keeper.

IMPORTANT

Do not climb up after him. He comes down in one step. You do not.

HOW TO

USING HIS INDOOR VOICE

SKILL 12 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 2 WEEKS · MEDIUM

A Bigfoot howl carries for eleven miles. Woodrow howls to say good night to the moon, to say good morning to the sun and to say he has found a raspberry. The neighbors have been very understanding, but they would like to sleep.

1



Agree on Quiet Hours

Nine at night to seven in the morning. Write it on the calendar.

2



Show Him a Whisper

Finger to the lips. He will copy it, enormously.

3



Ring the Quiet Bell

One ding means 'softer'. Two dings means 'much softer'.

MATERIALS



A small bell



A blanket



A clock with a loud tick



Cotton for your ears



A quiet game

4



Practice a Hum Instead

A hum is a howl with its manners on.

5



Let Him Howl at Sunset

One good howl at sunset, from the oak tree. Everyone needs to let off steam.

NOTES

Soft music helps. Woodrow falls asleep to Bing Crosby every time, usually before the second verse.

IMPORTANT

Never howl back at him. He will take it as an invitation to sing all night.



6 *Tuck Him In*

A tired Bigfoot is a quiet Bigfoot.

HOW TO

KEEPING HIM OUT OF THE ICEBOX

SKILL 13 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · ONGOING · HARD

MATERIALS

- A strong latch



- A snack shelf



- A wicker basket



- A bushel of apples



- A friendly note



A Bigfoot eats about forty pounds of food a day. Given the chance, he will eat it all at once, at two in the morning, standing in front of the open icebox. The milk, the cold ham and Sunday's pie will all be gone. Some kindly firmness is required.

1



Count What Is Missing

Two pies, a ham and the pickles. Yes, the pickles.

2



Fit a Latch

A good brass latch, high up, where big fingers fumble.

3

Make Him a Snack Basket

Apples, carrots, a loaf of bread. His own, in the woodshed.



4



Show Him the Basket

Hand it over and say 'Woodrow's'. He understands ownership very well.

5



Set Meal Times

Breakfast, lunch, supper and one snack at four. Ring the bell.

6



Leave a Night Snack Out

A sandwich on the counter at bedtime saves the whole icebox.

NOTES

He loves frozen peas as a treat on hot days. Keep a bag in the freezer just for him.

IMPORTANT

Never padlock the icebox with Father inside the kitchen at night. That is a separate problem.

HOW TO

BEDTIME AND THE BIG BLANKET

SKILL 14 · HOUSE RULES FOR A BIG FELLOW · 30 MINUTES · EASY

Even a Bigfoot needs a bedtime, and Woodrow needs one more than most. Without it, he wanders, he howls and he eats the porch geraniums. With it, he sleeps like a big hairy baby until the rooster gets up.

1



Ring the Bedtime Bell

Eight o'clock sharp. Even in summer.

2



Warm Milk in a Mug

A big mug. Actually, a mixing bowl.

3



Walk Him to the Woodshed

Hold the lantern. He likes to see where he is going.

MATERIALS



Two quilts sewn together



A storybook



A cup of warm milk



A lantern



A soft pillow

4



Tuck in the Big Blanket

Two quilts sewn together. Tuck in the corners firmly.

5



Read One Story

Just one. He will ask for another. Be strong.

NOTES

Woodrow's favorite story is 'The Three Bears'. He sides with the bears.

IMPORTANT

Never read him a story about hunters. He will stay up all night watching the window.



6 *Blow Out the Lantern*

Say good night, close the door and do not look back.

CHAPTER THREE

3

TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT

Bibs, napkins and passing the potatoes







A family that eats together stays together, and that goes double when one member of the family can eat a whole ham in two bites. Woodrow came to us with no table manners at all. He ate with his hands, drank from the gravy boat and tried to eat the centerpiece. Today he says grace, uses a napkin and passes the potatoes to the left. It can be done. Here is how.

IN THIS CHAPTER

15 Setting a Place for a Sasquatch
16 Using a Napkin Instead of His Arm
17 Flipping Pancakes by the Dozen
18 Saying Grace and Waiting His Turn
19 Eating His Vegetables (Not the Centerpiece)
20 Passing the Potatoes Politely
21 Helping With the Dishes

HOW TO

SETTING A PLACE FOR A SASQUATCH

SKILL 15 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · 15 MINUTES · EASY

An ordinary place setting will not do. A dinner plate is a saucer to him and a fork is a toothpick. Set his place with things from the kitchen cupboards and the garden shed, and set it with the same care you would for the minister.

1



Pull Out the Bench

His end of the table, near the kitchen, where the floor is linoleum.

2



Use a Mixing Bowl

The big yellow one. It is now his.

3

Lay a Serving Spoon

A fork is too small. A serving spoon is just right.



4



Fill a Big Tin Cup

Milk or water. Never coffee after four.

5



Tie On His Bib

A striped bath towel, tied at the back of the neck. Not too tight.

6



Admire the Table

Light the candles. It is a proper family supper.

NOTES

Put a rubber mat under his bowl. It stops the bowl sliding when he gets excited about dessert.

IMPORTANT

Never put the gravy boat within his reach. He thinks it is a drink.

MATERIALS

- A big mixing bowl



- A serving spoon



- A bath towel bib



- A sturdy bench



- A big tin cup



HOW TO

USING A NAPKIN INSTEAD OF HIS ARM

SKILL 16 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · 1 MONTH · MEDIUM

Woodrow wipes his mouth on his arm, and his arm is very hairy, so the gravy stays there until bath day. A napkin is the gentleman's answer. Teach it slowly, with a great deal of praise, and keep a stack of tea towels handy.

MATERIALS


A stack of tea towels


A napkin ring (a bracelet will do)


A mirror


A bowl of gravy (for practice)


Patience

1



Choose a Big Napkin

A tea towel. Folded once. Never paper.

2



Show Him a Dab

Dab, dab, fold. Do it slowly, with a smile.

3



Tuck It In

Tuck a corner under his chin before every meal.

4



Hold Up the Mirror

Let him see the gravy. He will be horrified, and then he will learn.

5



Praise Every Wipe

'What a gentleman!' He will wipe again just to hear it.



6 ### *Wash the Napkins*

Every day, in hot water. There will be a lot of napkins.

NOTES

Give him a napkin ring of his own. Ours is an old horseshoe painted gold, and he is very proud of it.

IMPORTANT

Do not let the children teach him to blow his nose in the napkin. They will, if you let them.

HOW TO

FLIPPING PANCAKES BY THE DOZEN

SKILL 17 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Saturday is pancake day, and in a Bigfoot household pancake day is a major event. Woodrow eats forty-eight pancakes at a sitting. Father has become the fastest flipper in the county. With practice, so can you.

MATERIALS

- Two griddles



- A big bowl of batter



- A long spatula



- A pound of butter



- A gallon of maple syrup



1



Heat Both Griddles

Two at once, or you will never catch up.

2



Pour in Rows

Six to a griddle, in neat rows, like a parade.

3

Flip With Flair

A flick of the wrist. The children will cheer.



4



Stack Them High

Twelve to a stack, butter between every third.

5



Pour the Syrup

Hold the jug high so it comes down in a thin golden ribbon.

6



Serve the Big Fellow First

Then everyone else. He has been waiting since six.

NOTES

Keep the finished stacks warm in the oven on low. Cold pancakes are a tragedy, even for a Bigfoot.

IMPORTANT

Do not flip pancakes toward the ceiling fan. We learned this the hard way.

HOW TO

SAYING GRACE AND WAITING HIS TURN

SKILL 18 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · 2 MINUTES · EASY

Grace before supper is a family custom, and Woodrow has taken to it beautifully. He bows his great head, closes his eyes and waits. The waiting is the hard part. A Bigfoot can smell pot roast from a mile away, and here it is right under his nose.

MATERIALS


A family at the table


A hot supper


Folded hands


A short prayer


A little self-control

1



Sit Everyone Down

Hands in laps. Nobody touches a roll.

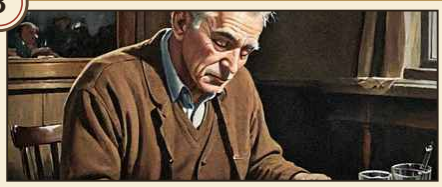
2



Fold Your Hands

Show him how. He folds his like two big hairy loaves of bread.

3



Bow Your Head

Grandfather says the words. Short and sweet. He knows his audience.

4



Say Amen Together

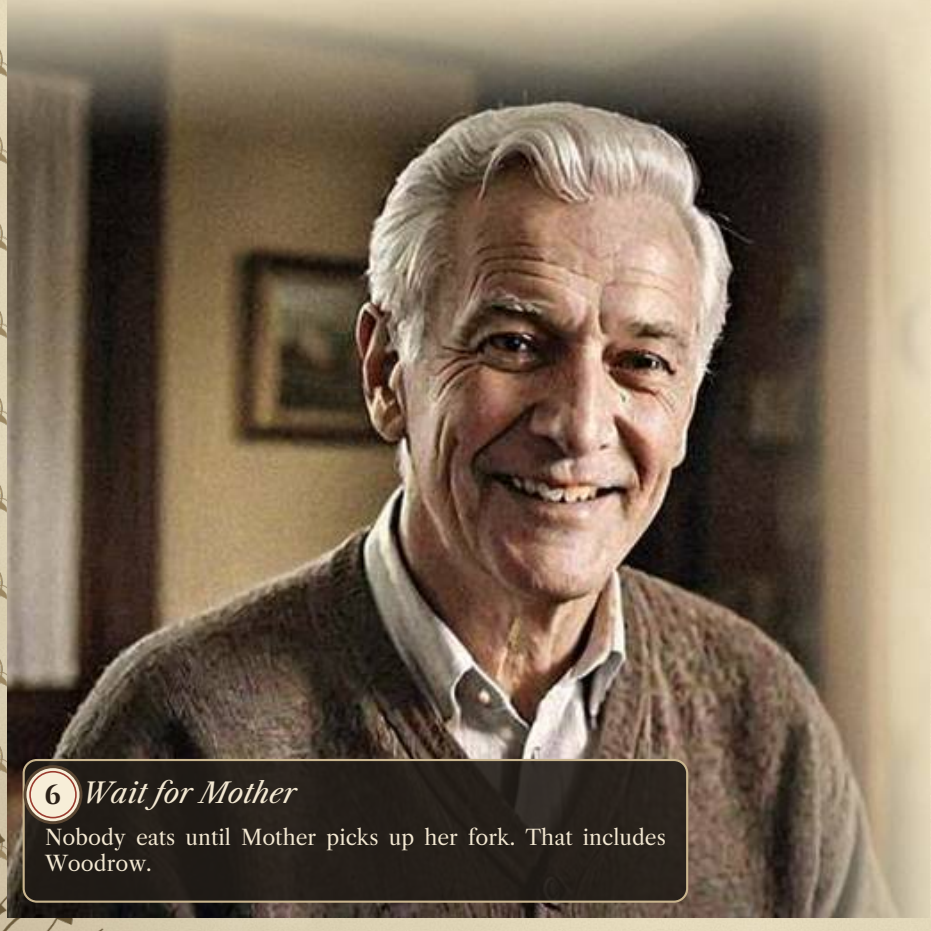
Woodrow says it as a sort of rumble. It counts.

5



Pass to the Guest First

The minister, the visitor, then Woodrow. In that order.



6 ### *Wait for Mother*

Nobody eats until Mother picks up her fork. That includes Woodrow.

NOTES

Let him say grace once a month. It is a long, low rumble and nobody knows what it means, but it is very moving.

IMPORTANT

Do not say grace for too long. A Bigfoot's patience lasts exactly as long as the gravy stays hot.

HOW TO

EATING HIS VEGETABLES (NOT THE CENTERPIECE)

SKILL 19 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · EVERY MEAL · HARD

Woodrow will eat pine cones, tree bark and the flowers in the middle of the table, but he will not eat his peas. Like all children, he must be persuaded. Like all children, he can be.

1



Move the Flowers

Real flowers go on the sideboard. Wax fruit goes on the table. He will learn.

2



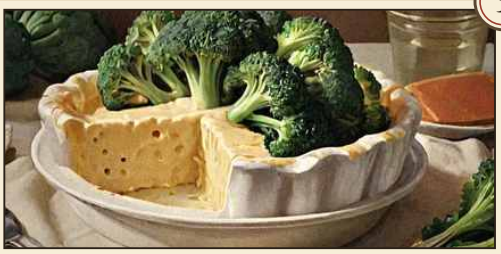
Serve Small Portions

Small for him is one cup. Start there.

3

Add Cheese Sauce

Everything is better with cheese sauce. Even broccoli. Even for a Bigfoot.



4



Make Carrots Into Sticks

He likes things he can hold. Carrot sticks feel like twigs.

5



Eat Yours First

He watches everything you do. Eat your peas with relish.

6



Praise the Empty Bowl

Cheer, clap and offer dessert. Dessert is the point.

NOTES

Fresh peas from the pod are a game, not a vegetable. Give him a basket of pods to shell and they vanish.

IMPORTANT

Never use real pine cones as table decorations. He thinks they are hors d'oeuvres.

MATERIALS

- A bowl of buttered peas



- Carrots cut in sticks



- A dish of cheese sauce



- A fake centerpiece



- A spoon for airplanes



HOW TO

PASSING THE POTATOES POLITELY

SKILL 20 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · EVERY SUPPER · MEDIUM

'Please pass the potatoes' is the most important sentence at any American table. Woodrow's version used to be reaching over the whole family and taking the bowl. Now he asks, with a sort of grunt and a point, and waits. Here is how we taught him.

MATERIALS


A bowl of mashed potatoes


A gravy boat


A dinner roll basket


A family


A big napkin

1



Explain the Rule

We pass to the left. We do not reach. We say please.

2



Practice With Rolls

Rolls are good for practice. Nothing spills.

3



Hand Over the Potatoes

Hold the bowl with both hands. It is heavy and so is the responsibility.

4



Wait for 'Thank You'

A grunt and a nod counts as thank you from a Bigfoot.

5



Pass It On

Make sure it reaches Grandmother before it is empty.



6 *Pass the Gravy Last*

Separately. And keep your eye on it.

NOTES

A lazy Susan in the middle of the table spins the dishes to everyone. Woodrow thinks it is magic.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him pass the potatoes by throwing them. He is very accurate, but Mother is not amused.

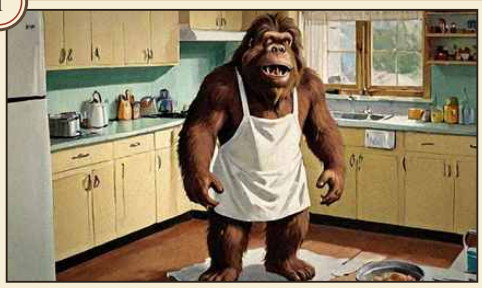
HOW TO

HELPING WITH THE DISHES

SKILL 21 · TABLE MANNERS FOR BIGFOOT · 30 MINUTES · EASY

Woodrow loves the dishes. He loves the warm water, the bubbles and the squeak of a clean plate. Unfortunately, he squeezes a little too hard. With the right jobs, a Bigfoot can be the best dishwasher in the county.

1



Tie On His Apron

A bedsheet with ties. It makes him feel official.

2



Give Him the Pots

Pots cannot break. Pots are his job.

3

Show Him a Gentle Scrub

Round and round, not up and down. Gently.



4



Let Him Dry

Drying is safer than washing. He holds a towel like a flag.

5



Put the China Up High

You do the good plates yourself. Every time.

6



Finish With Bubbles

Blow a few bubbles at the end. He will laugh until the windows rattle.

NOTES

Tin camping plates are unbreakable and he can wash them as hard as he likes.

IMPORTANT

Never let him dry the glasses. We have bought three sets this year.

MATERIALS

- A dishpan of hot soapy water



- Tin plates



- Two dish towels



- A drying rack



- An apron (extra large)



CHAPTER FOUR

4

GROOMING A GENTLEMAN

Burrs, baths in the yard and the shedding season







Woodrow arrived with half the forest in his fur: burrs, pine needles, two bird nests and a fishing lure. He smelled like a wet dog who had been rolling in a Christmas tree. A gentleman is known by his grooming, and a Bigfoot is no exception. It takes a big brush, a garden hose and a great deal of patience, but the result is a fellow you can take to church.

IN THIS CHAPTER

22 Brushing Out the Burrs
23 Bath Day With the Garden Hose
24 Drying a Very Wet Bigfoot
25 Trimming His Toenails
26 Brushing His Big Teeth
27 Dealing With the Forest Smell
28 Surviving the Shedding Season

HOW TO

BRUSHING OUT THE BURRS

SKILL 22 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Every walk in the woods comes home in Woodrow's fur. Burrs, twigs, pine needles and the occasional surprised chipmunk. Brush him every evening on the back porch and you will never have to do it with garden shears.

1



Sit Him on the Steps

Back porch, evening light. He will sit still for a good long brushing.

2



Start at the Top

Stand on a footstool. Work down from the shoulders like brushing a horse.

3



Pick Out the Burrs

By hand, one at a time, into the paper sack.

MATERIALS


A horse brush


A wide-tooth comb


A paper sack for burrs


A footstool


A cup of tea

4



Comb the Tangles

Hold the fur near the skin and comb gently. He is ticklish under the arms.

5



Check for Visitors

Chipmunks, beetles, the odd fishing lure. Return them to the woods.

NOTES

A spoonful of mineral oil on the brush brings out a lovely sheen, and the burrs slide right out.

IMPORTANT

Do not brush him against the grain. He will sneeze, and a Bigfoot sneeze will take the pins out of your hair.



6 *Admire the Shine*

Step back. He looks like a new fur coat in a department store window.

HOW TO

BATH DAY WITH THE GARDEN HOSE

SKILL 23 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 1 AFTERNOON · HARD

Woodrow does not fit in the bathtub. We tried once, and the plumber is still talking about it. Bath day happens in the backyard, on a warm Saturday, with the garden hose, a bucket of suds and the whole family in raincoats.

MATERIALS

- A garden hose



- A bucket of soap suds



- A long-handled scrub brush



- Raincoats for everyone



- A warm sunny day



1



Pick a Warm Day

Seventy degrees or more. A shivering Bigfoot is a cross Bigfoot.

2



Put On Raincoats

Everyone, including Grandmother. You will see why.

3

Wet Him Down

Start with the lawn sprinkler. It is gentler than the hose, and he thinks it is a game.



4



Scrub With a Long Brush

A long-handled deck brush and plenty of suds.

5



Rinse Him Off

Rinse until the water runs clear. This takes a while.

6



Let Him Shake

Stand well back. He shakes like a dog, but eight feet tall.

NOTES

Add a cup of vinegar to the rinse water. It cuts the forest smell and leaves him fresh as laundry.

IMPORTANT

Never use the bathtub. The bathtub is for people. Woodrow is washed outdoors, standing on the lawn, every time.

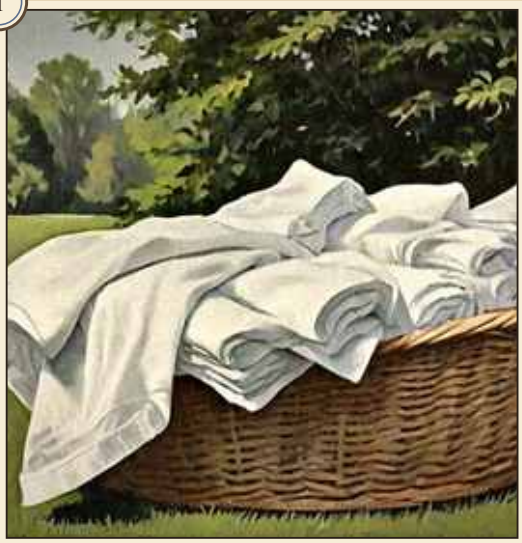
HOW TO

DRYING A VERY WET BIGFOOT

SKILL 24 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 2 HOURS · EASY

A wet Bigfoot holds about twelve gallons of water and smells like a wet sheepdog the size of a refrigerator. Do not let him in the house until he is dry. Sunshine, bedsheets and a good brisk rub do the job.

1



Fetch the Bedsheets

Bath towels are too small. Use the old sheets.

2



Wrap Him Up

Drape a sheet over his shoulders like a cape.

3



Rub Briskly

Big circles. He likes it. He will close his eyes and hum.

MATERIALS


Six old bedsheets


A clothesline


A sunny spot


A big brush


A cold lemonade

4



Hang the Sheets Out

They will be soaking. Hang them out as you go.

5



Sit Him in the Sun

Half an hour in the sun with a lemonade does the rest.

NOTES

A dry Bigfoot is a fluffy Bigfoot. Take a photograph. It will be the nicest one of the year.

IMPORTANT

Do not use Mother's hair dryer. It blew a fuse, and he was frightened of it for a month.



6 *Brush Him Fluffy*

A quick brush when he is dry. He will be twice the size.

HOW TO

TRIMMING HIS TOENAILS

SKILL 25 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 45 MINUTES · HARD

Long toenails click on the kitchen floor, tear holes in the doormat and leave scratches on the porch. Woodrow's grow about an inch a month. Trimming them is a two-person job, best done after supper when he is sleepy.

MATERIALS

- Garden pruning shears



- A big metal file



- A footstool



- A newspaper



- A bowl of cherries



1



Wait Until He Is Sleepy

After supper, in his chair, with the radio on.

2



Spread a Newspaper

Clippings fly. Some of them are the size of guitar picks.

3

Prop Up the Foot

Rest it on a footstool. It is heavy, so lift with your knees.



4



Trim Straight Across

Garden pruning shears, one nail at a time, not too short.

5



File the Edges

A big metal file smooths them. He will giggle.

6



Reward With Cherries

A bowl of cherries for a brave Bigfoot.

NOTES

Soak his feet in a tub of warm water first. The nails soften and the job goes twice as fast.

IMPORTANT

Never trim them while he is awake and watching. He will pull his foot away just as you squeeze.

HOW TO

BRUSHING HIS BIG TEETH

SKILL 26 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 10 MINUTES · EASY

A Bigfoot smile is a wonderful thing: wide, warm and full of teeth. To keep it that way, those teeth need brushing twice a day. Woodrow uses a scrub brush, a whole tube of toothpaste and a bucket of water. He loves the foam.

1



Get His Own Brush

A new scrub brush, never used for floors. Write his name on the handle.

2



Squeeze the Whole Tube

He needs all of it. Do not argue.

3



Show Him How

Up and down, not side to side. Do it with your own toothbrush.

MATERIALS


A new scrub brush


Toothpaste (a whole tube)


A bucket of water


A tin cup


A hand mirror

4



Let Him Brush

Up and down, top and bottom. Lots of foam.

5



Rinse and Spit

Into the flower bed. The roses do not seem to mind.

NOTES

Peppermint toothpaste is best. He makes a face at spearmint.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him brush indoors. He will foam over the sink, the floor and the cat.



6 *Smile for the Mirror*

Hold up the mirror. He will grin for ten minutes.

HOW TO

DEALING WITH THE FOREST SMELL

SKILL 27 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · ONGOING · MEDIUM

Woodrow smells of pine needles, wet earth and mushrooms. Outdoors it is lovely. Indoors, in August, it is a great deal of forest in a small kitchen. A good homemaker can manage it with fresh air, lavender and a little cleverness.

MATERIALS

- Bunches of dried lavender



- Baking soda



- A pine-scented candle



- Open windows



- Clean sheets for his bed



1



Open the Windows
All of them. Fresh air is free.

2



Hang Lavender in the Woodshed
Bunches from the rafters. He likes the purple.

3

Sprinkle Baking Soda
On his rug and on his straw. Sweep it up next morning.



4



Wash His Bedding
Once a week, hot water and sunshine.

5



Light a Pine Candle
If you cannot beat the forest, join it.

6



Tuck a Sprig Behind His Ear
A sprig of lavender behind his ear. He looks very distinguished.

NOTES

A cotton sack of cedar shavings under his pillow keeps the woodshed smelling like a cedar chest.

IMPORTANT

Never use perfume on him. He sneezes, and then he smells like the perfume counter at Woolworth's for a week.

HOW TO

SURVIVING THE SHEDDING SEASON

SKILL 28 · GROOMING A GENTLEMAN · 6 WEEKS EVERY SPRING · HARD

Every spring Woodrow sheds his winter coat. All of it. For six weeks, there is fur on the sofa, fur in the butter and fur drifting down the street like dandelion fluff. There is no stopping it. There is only managing it.

1



Brush Him Outside Daily

A stiff garden rake, gently. It comes off in clumps.

2



Sweep Every Morning

Before breakfast, every room. He sheds in his sleep.

3



Bag the Fur

Burlap sacks, stuffed full. Do not throw it out.

MATERIALS


A stiff rake


Lint rollers by the dozen


A broom


Burlap sacks


A good sense of humor

4



Give It to the Birds

Birds line their nests with it. Hang tufts on the fence.

5



Keep Lint Rollers Handy

At the front door, for visitors. Everyone leaves fuzzy.

NOTES

Turn the fur into a project. Grandmother spun some into yarn and knitted Woodrow a scarf from his own coat. He did not understand, but he loves it.

IMPORTANT

Never vacuum near him during shedding season. He is terrified of the vacuum cleaner, and you will find him on the roof.



6 ### *Stuff a Pillow With It*

Grandmother's idea. It is the softest pillow in the county.

CHAPTER FIVE

5

OUT AND ABOUT

Disguises, the station wagon and a trip to the hardware store







Sooner or later a Bigfoot wants to see the world beyond the backyard. Woodrow watched the station wagon leave every morning and came to the conclusion that town must be wonderful. He was right. Town is wonderful. It is also full of people with cameras and opinions. This chapter covers outings, disguises and how to bring everyone home again.

IN THIS CHAPTER

29 Taking Him for a Drive
30 Disguising Him as Uncle Walter
31 A Trip to the Hardware Store
32 Walking Down Main Street
33 Visiting the Barbershop
34 Sitting in the Back Pew at Church
35 Dodging the Newspaper Photographer

HOW TO

TAKING HIM FOR A DRIVE

SKILL 29 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Woodrow loves the station wagon. He loves the wind, the speed and the cows. Fitting him in is the hard part. Fold down the back seat, open the tailgate window and take the back roads.

1



Fold Down the Seats

All the way flat. Put down a blanket. He sheds.

2



Help Him In

Through the tailgate, head first. He will figure out the rest.

3

Take the Back Roads

Fewer people, more cows. He likes cows.



4



Roll the Window Down

Let him put his head out like a happy dog.

5



Stop at a Fruit Stand

Father goes alone. Woodrow waits under the blanket.

6



Home Before Dark

Headlights make him wave at oncoming cars. Not ideal.

NOTES

He sits better in the back if he has a job. Woodrow holds the picnic basket and takes it very seriously.

IMPORTANT

Never take the station wagon through a car wash with him in it. He thought it was a monster and he was not entirely wrong.

MATERIALS

- A station wagon



- A blanket for the back



- A road map



- A bag of apples



- A full tank of gas



HOW TO

DISGUISING HIM AS UNCLE WALTER

SKILL 30 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · HARD

In town, Woodrow is Uncle Walter from Oregon. Uncle Walter is very tall, very hairy and very shy. He wears a raincoat, a large hat and dark glasses, and nobody has questioned it yet. Mostly they are too polite.

MATERIALS


An extra-large trench coat


A wide-brimmed hat


Dark glasses


A long scarf


Big galoshes

1



Find a Big Coat

The church rummage sale. Ask for the biggest coat they have, then two more.

2



Add a Hat

Wide brim, pulled low. Covers the forehead and most of the eyebrows.

3



Dark Glasses

Big ones. They also help with the photographers.

4



Wrap the Scarf

Long, wound three times. Covers the chin and the grin.

5



Check the Mirror

Turn him around. If he looks like a tall uncle, he passes.



6 ### *Practice the Nod*

Uncle Walter does not talk. He nods. Practice the nod.

NOTES

Galoshes hide the feet. The feet are always the giveaway.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him take the hat off to be polite in church. Uncle Walter keeps his hat on and everyone has accepted it.

HOW TO

A TRIP TO THE HARDWARE STORE

SKILL 31 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Woodrow likes the hardware store more than any place in town. It smells of wood and oil, and it is full of things he can hold. Mr. Gruber behind the counter has accepted Uncle Walter as a regular. Woodrow carries the heavy things and everybody wins.

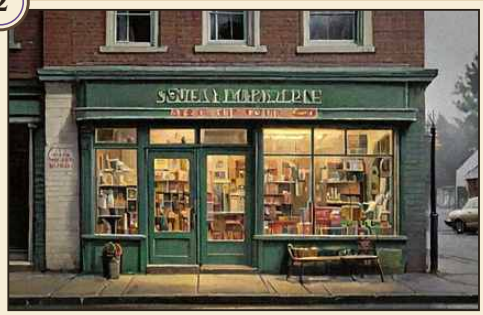
1



Write a Short List

Nails, paint, a new rake. Short lists mean short trips.

2



Go Early

Nine o'clock, before the farmers come in.

3

Let Him Carry the Heavy Things

Sacks of feed, bags of cement. He is a great help.



4



Keep Him Out of the Nail Aisle

He likes to run his fingers through the nail bins. They go everywhere.

5



Pay at the Counter

Father pays. Uncle Walter nods.

6



Load the Wagon

He lifts the whole wagon into the station wagon. Let him.

NOTES

Mr. Gruber keeps a jar of peppermints on the counter. One for Uncle Walter keeps him calm through the checkout.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him test the rakes on the store floor. It is a store, not a lawn.

MATERIALS

- A shopping list



- Your wallet



- The disguise



- A sturdy wagon



- Patience in the nail aisle



HOW TO

WALKING DOWN MAIN STREET

SKILL 32 · OUT AND ABOUT · 30 MINUTES · HARD

A walk down Main Street is the real test. There are shop windows, dogs, children with ice cream and Mrs. Pruitt's sister. Keep the walk short, keep to the shady side and always have a plan for getting back to the station wagon.

MATERIALS


The disguise


A little leash (for show)


A coin purse


An ice cream cone


A good story

1



Park Close

The far end of Main Street, near the park.

2



Walk on the Shady Side

Under the awnings. Fewer people look up.

3



Stop at the Barber Pole

He loves the barber pole. Let him watch it for a minute.

4



Buy Him an Ice Cream

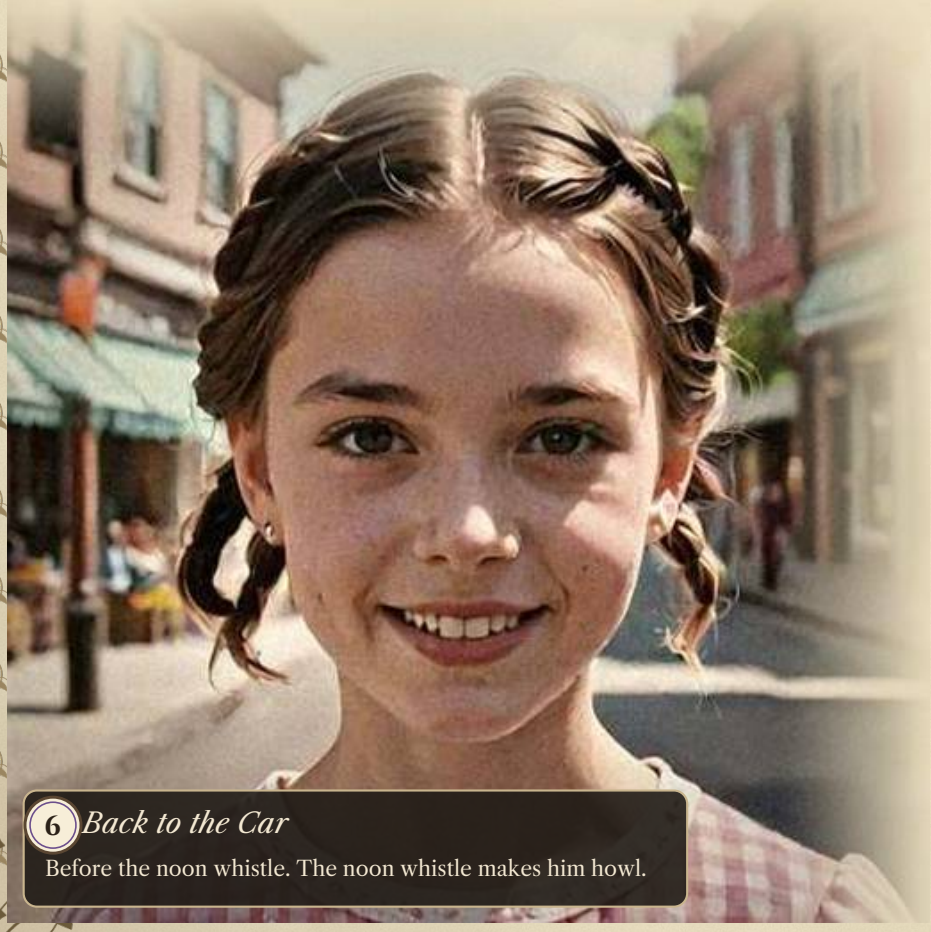
Two scoops. It gives him something to do with his hands.

5



Smile and Keep Moving

If anyone stares, smile and say 'He is from Oregon'.



6 *Back to the Car*

Before the noon whistle. The noon whistle makes him howl.

NOTES

Walk him past the pet shop window. The puppies love him and it puts everyone in a good mood.

IMPORTANT

Never walk him past the butcher's window. He will press his face to the glass and the butcher will call the sheriff.

HOW TO

VISITING THE BARBERSHOP

SKILL 33 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · HARD

Once a year, before the church picnic, Woodrow gets a trim. Not a haircut. A trim. Gus the barber has been sworn to secrecy and paid in rhubarb pie. Go after closing time, pull the blinds and bring a lot of towels.

1



Go After Closing
Six o'clock. Gus pulls the blinds.

2



Fit Him in the Chair
He will not fit. He sits on the floor and Gus stands on the chair.

3

Trim the Bangs
Just enough to see his eyes. He has lovely eyes.



4



Tidy the Eyebrows
Gus calls them 'the hedges'.

5



Sweep Up the Pile
There will be a pile. A big one.

6



Pay With Pie
Gus prefers pie. Leave a generous tip in pie.

NOTES

Splash a little bay rum on him at the end. He will sniff his own arm all the way home.

IMPORTANT

Never let Gus use the electric clippers. The buzzing sends him straight out the door, cape and all.

MATERIALS

- Gus the barber



- A rhubarb pie



- Every towel in the house



- A big broom



- A flower for his lapel



HOW TO

SITTING IN THE BACK PEW AT CHURCH

SKILL 34 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Woodrow likes church. He likes the organ, the singing and the stained glass. He sits in the back pew, in his Uncle Walter disguise, between Grandmother and the wall. Reverend Peabody says he has never had a more attentive listener.

MATERIALS


The disguise

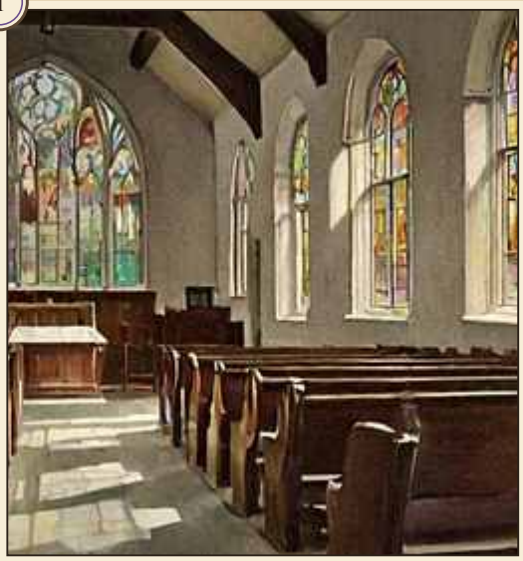

A hymnal (large print)


A handkerchief


A peppermint


Your Sunday best

1



Arrive Early

Before the crowd. Take the back pew by the wall.
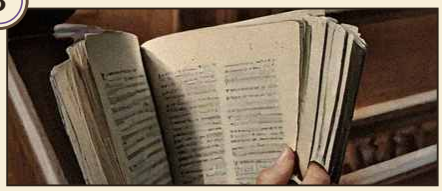
2



Sit by the Wall

Grandmother on the aisle. Woodrow by the wall. Nobody gets past Grandmother.

3



Share the Hymnal

Hold it up for him. He hums along, very low.

4



Pass Him a Peppermint

During the sermon. It keeps him still.

5



Stand for the Hymns

He stands very slowly, so as not to block the stained glass.



6 *Shake the Reverend's Hand*

On the way out. Gently. The Reverend has had one surgery already.

NOTES

Sit near an open window in summer. He gets warm in the trench coat.

IMPORTANT

Do not sit near the organ. When the organ plays a low note, he answers it.

HOW TO

DODGING THE NEWSPAPER PHOTOGRAPHER

SKILL 35 · OUT AND ABOUT · AS NEEDED · HARD

Mr. Finch from the Pine Hollow Gazette has been trying to photograph Woodrow since October. He hides in hedges, he sits in trees and he once dressed as a mailbox. Woodrow thinks it is a game. For the family, it is a matter of privacy.

1



Spot the Flash

A flash in the hedge means Mr. Finch is back.

2



Open the Umbrella

A big black umbrella hides a Bigfoot from most angles.

3

Walk Him Behind the Woodshed

Calmly. Running makes for better photographs.



4



Offer Mr. Finch Coffee

It is hard to sneak about with a cup of coffee in your hand.

5



Let Him Take One Picture

Of the footprints. Everybody wins.

6



Read the Gazette

'Local Footprint Puzzles Experts.' Perfect.

NOTES

Blurry photographs are your friend. Ask Woodrow to wave. He waves so fast he is always a blur.

IMPORTANT

Never chase the photographer with the garden hose. Wet photographers write very cross articles.

MATERIALS

- A big umbrella



- A garden hose (just in case)



- A pot of coffee



- A friendly smile



- Mr. Finch's phone number



CHAPTER SIX

6

CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT

Firewood, groceries and moving the piano







An idle Bigfoot is a Bigfoot on the roof. Woodrow is happiest when he is useful, and he is very, very useful. He splits a winter's firewood in an afternoon, carries the groceries in one trip and can move the piano with one hand while Mother sweeps underneath. Give him a job, show him how and say thank you. That is all a good worker of any size needs.

IN THIS CHAPTER

36 Splitting the Winter Firewood
37 Carrying the Groceries in One Trip
38 Raking the Autumn Leaves
39 Shoveling the Snow
40 Reaching the High Shelves
41 Moving the Piano

HOW TO

SPLITTING THE WINTER FIREWOOD

SKILL 36 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Father used to split firewood every Saturday from October to Christmas. Now Woodrow does it in one afternoon, and Father supervises from a lawn chair. It took some teaching. The first day he split the chopping block, the axe handle and the wheelbarrow.

1



Show Him the Axe

Father demonstrates. Slow, steady, eyes on the log.

2



Hand It Over Carefully

Handle first. Always.

3



Let Him Try

One log at a time. Gently.

MATERIALS



An axe



A chopping block



A wheelbarrow



Work gloves



A lemonade for the supervisor

4



Stack It Neatly

Bark side up, in rows along the fence.

5



Fill the Wheelbarrow

For the house. He pushes it with one finger.

NOTES

Woodrow can split logs with his hands, but do not encourage it. The neighbors hear the cracking and worry.

IMPORTANT

Keep the children well back from the chopping block. Wood chips fly a long way when Woodrow is enthusiastic.



6 *Supervise With Lemonade*

Somebody has to.

HOW TO

CARRYING THE GROCERIES IN ONE TRIP

SKILL 37 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 10 MINUTES · EASY

In most households, carrying in the groceries takes three trips and an argument. In ours, Woodrow carries in eleven bags at once, plus the watermelon, plus the boy. The trick is teaching him that eggs are not the same as potatoes.

MATERIALS

- Paper grocery bags



- A dozen eggs



- A watermelon



- A big basket



- A kind word



1



Open the Tailgate

He waits by the car the moment he hears it in the drive.

2



Eggs Go in the Basket

Mother carries the eggs. Always.

3

Load Him Up

Two bags on each arm, two in each hand, watermelon under the chin.



4



Hold the Door

Wide open. He bumps the frame otherwise.

5



Unpack Together

He hands things to you. You put them away.

6



Say Thank You

Every time. He glows.

NOTES

Put the bread on top. He knows to be careful with the bread.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him carry the boy and the eggs at the same time. He gets them confused.

HOW TO

RAKING THE AUTUMN LEAVES

SKILL 38 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Raking leaves with Woodrow takes ten minutes. Jumping in the leaves with Woodrow takes the rest of the afternoon. Plan for both, because you will not stop him, and you will not want to.

1



Hand Out the Rakes
He holds two rakes, one in each hand.

2



Rake Into One Pile
One big pile in the middle of the lawn.

3



Watch Him Jump
He jumps. The leaves go everywhere.

MATERIALS


Three rakes


Burlap sacks


A wheelbarrow


Warm sweaters


A thermos of cocoa

4



Rake It Up Again
This is part of the job now.

5



Bag the Leaves
Stuff them in sacks. He stamps them down.

NOTES

Save one pile for jumping and one for raking. Everyone is happier.

IMPORTANT

Check the pile before he jumps. Grandfather sometimes naps in it.



6 *Cocoa on the Porch*
Everyone, with leaves in their hair.

HOW TO

SHOVELING THE SNOW

SKILL 39 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 30 MINUTES · EASY

MATERIALS

- A coal shovel



- A snow pusher



- Rock salt



- Mittens (yours)



- Hot cocoa



Woodrow loves snow. He grew up in it. He clears the driveway, the path, the porch and the Hendersons' walk before Father has found his gloves. He also builds a snowman taller than the house, which is the price you pay.

1



Give Him the Big Shovel

A coal shovel. It is the only one he does not bend.

2



Start With the Path

Front door to the street. Then the driveway.

3

Clear the Driveway

He can do the whole driveway in four shovelfuls.



4



Salt the Steps

Father does this. It is his contribution.

5



Help the Neighbors

He does the Hendersons' walk too. They leave out cookies.

6



Admire the Snowman

There will be a snowman. It will be twelve feet tall.

NOTES

He clears snow faster if you sing. 'Jingle Bells' doubles his speed.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him throw snowballs. A Bigfoot snowball is the size of a beach ball.

HOW TO

REACHING THE HIGH SHELVES

SKILL 40 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 5 MINUTES · EASY

A Bigfoot can reach the top shelf of any cupboard without a stepladder. He can reach the attic hatch, the kite stuck in the elm tree and the cobwebs in the stairwell. Every household with a Bigfoot throws away its stepladder within a month.

1



Ask Nicely

Point and say 'Please, Woodrow'. He loves to be asked.

2



The Top Shelf

Grandmother's cake tin lives up there. Now she can have it.

3



Change a Light Bulb

No stepladder. No wobbling. No falling.

MATERIALS


A tall cupboard


A feather duster


A kite in a tree


A light bulb


A kind 'please'

4



Dust the Cobwebs

Hand him the feather duster. He tickles the ceiling.

5



Fetch the Kite

The one stuck in the elm since last spring.

NOTES

Keep a list of high jobs on the icebox. When he is restless, give him the list.

IMPORTANT

Do not ask him to reach the attic. He will go up, and you will hear him walking on the ceiling all afternoon.



6 *Say Thank You*

He will bow. Bow back.

HOW TO

MOVING THE PIANO

SKILL 41 · CHORES FOR A HELPFUL GIANT · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

MATERIALS

- An upright piano



- A broom
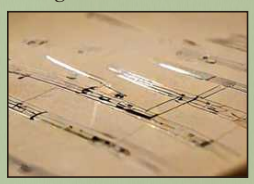


- A dust pan



- Felt pads



- A song sheet



Every spring Mother cleans behind the piano, and every spring it used to take Father, two neighbors and a long argument. Woodrow lifts it. He lifts it, he holds it while Mother sweeps and he puts it back exactly where it was. Then he plays a note.

1



Clear the Top

Vases, photographs and the metronome. He lifts carefully, but still.

2



Let Him Look It Over

He likes to inspect it first and play a few notes. Then both hands, from the bottom, slowly.

3

Sweep Underneath

Quickly. He is strong, but he gets bored.



4



Slip On Felt Pads

Under each foot, to save the floor.

5



Set It Down Gently

Exactly where it was. He has a very good eye.

6



Let Him Play One Note

Just one. Low C. He loves low C.

NOTES

Turn this into a piano lesson. He cannot play, but he loves the low notes and he is gentle with the keys.

IMPORTANT

Never ask him to move the piano upstairs. The stairs will not hold them both.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7

FUN AND GAMES

Catch, hide-and-seek and a tree house big enough







All work and no play makes a dull Bigfoot, and a dull Bigfoot eats the porch furniture. Woodrow loves games the way only a creature who has spent two hundred years alone in the woods can love games. He is a magnificent catcher, a terrible hider and the best campfire companion a family ever had. Here is how to play with a friend who is eight feet tall.

IN THIS CHAPTER

42 Teaching Him to Play Catch
43 Playing Hide-and-Seek (He Loses)
44 Camping Out in the Backyard
45 Building a Tree House Big Enough
46 Teaching Him to Dance
47 Roasting Marshmallows Safely
48 Playing Checkers (Not Eating Them)

HOW TO

TEACHING HIM TO PLAY CATCH

SKILL 42 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Woodrow catches anything. Baseballs, footballs, frisbees, apples and once a low-flying duck, which he set down politely. Throwing is another matter. His first throw went over the church steeple. Start with soft balls and a wide-open field.

MATERIALS


A rubber playground ball


A baseball mitt


An open field


A whistle


A lemonade

1



Start With a Soft Ball

A big red rubber ball. Nothing that can break a window.

2



Show Him a Gentle Toss

Underhand, nice and slow.

3



Let Him Catch

He never drops one. Cheer anyway.

4



Teach a Soft Throw

Underhand. Soft. Softer. Softer than that.

5



Step Back a Little

Ten paces. Then twenty. Never more than forty.



6 *Fetch the Ball From the Roof*

It will end up on the roof. He will fetch it.

NOTES

Give him a laundry basket to catch with. It slows him down and makes the game fair.

IMPORTANT

Never play catch near the Hendersons' greenhouse.

HOW TO

PLAYING HIDE-AND-SEEK (HE LOSES)

SKILL 43 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Woodrow's people have hidden from the world for hundreds of years. You would think he would be good at hide-and-seek. He is not. He hides behind the lamp post. He hides behind the birdbath. He giggles. The children adore it.

1



Pick a Counting Tree

The big oak. Eyes closed, count to fifty.

2



Watch Him Hide

Do not peek. You will not need to.

3

Find Him Right Away

Behind the birdbath. Pretend to look elsewhere first.



4



Act Very Surprised

'Woodrow! There you are!' He loves to be found.

5



Let Him Seek

He finds everyone in under a minute. He follows his nose.

6



Lemonade for Everyone

There are no losers in a game with lemonade.

NOTES

Teach him to hide in the woods instead. He is a different creature among the pine trees. You will never find him, so set a time limit.

IMPORTANT

Never hide in the woodshed. That is his room, and he finds it very confusing.

MATERIALS

- A big backyard



- A counting tree



- A handkerchief



- A loud voice



- Lemonade for the winners



HOW TO

CAMPING OUT IN THE BACKYARD

SKILL 44 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 NIGHT · MEDIUM

A backyard campout is a fine family tradition, and it is finer with a Bigfoot. He knows every star, he hears every owl and he can put up a tent in four seconds, mostly by accident. He also snores like a freight train.

MATERIALS


A canvas tent

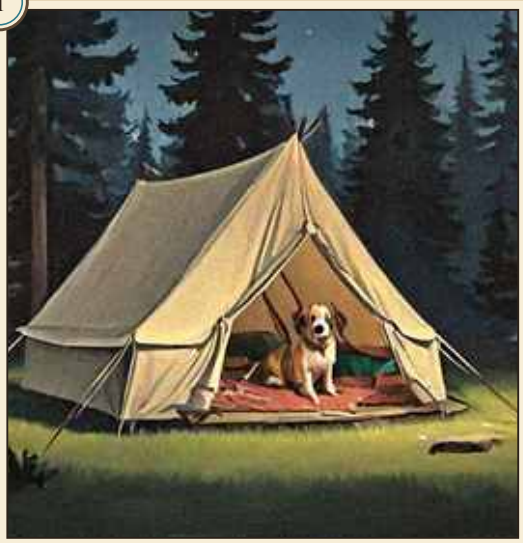

Sleeping bags


Flashlights


A camp lantern


Earmuffs (for the snoring)

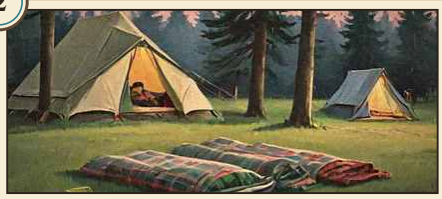
1



Pitch the Tent

Father reads the instructions. Woodrow holds the pole.

2



Roll Out the Sleeping Bags

His goes outside the tent. He does not fit inside.

3



Look at the Stars

He points out the Big Dipper. He calls it 'the Big Spoon'.

4



Tell Ghost Stories

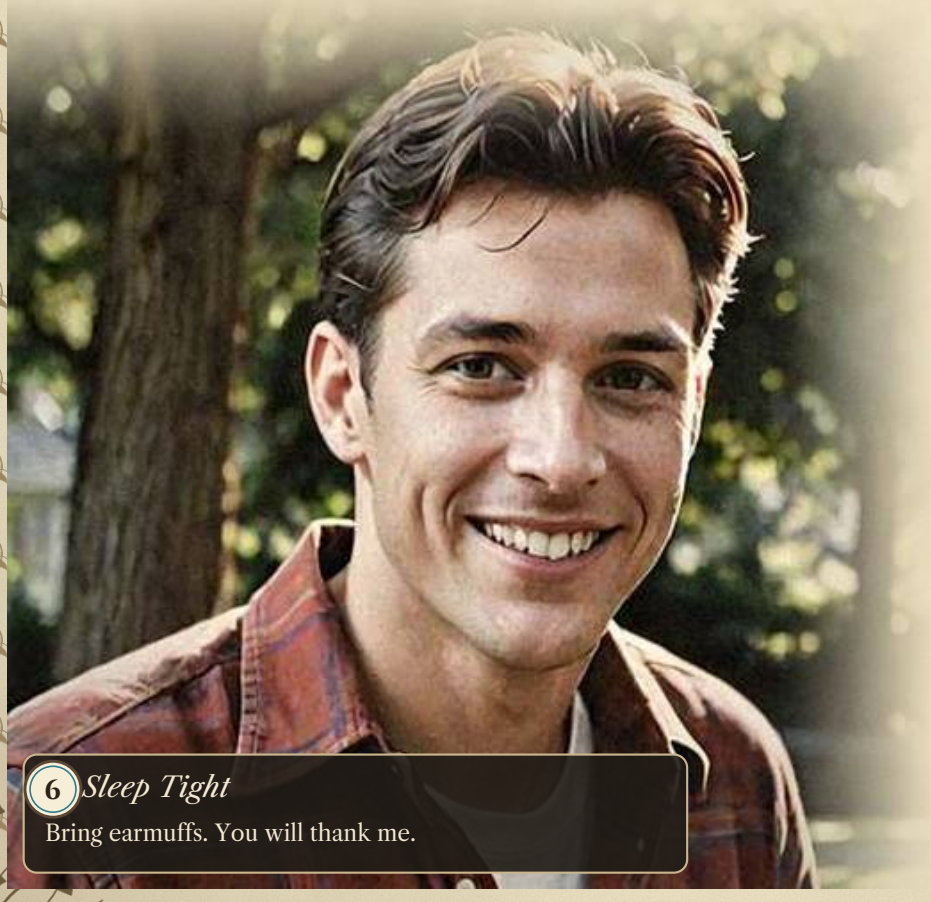
Nothing too scary. He hides under the sleeping bag.

5



Listen to the Owls

He hoots back. They answer.



6 *Sleep Tight*

Bring earmuffs. You will thank me.

NOTES

Pitch the tent near the house so the children can run in for the bathroom. Woodrow will guard the tent.

IMPORTANT

Do not pitch the tent under the oak tree. He climbs it at three in the morning.

HOW TO

BUILDING A TREE HOUSE BIG ENOUGH

SKILL 45 · FUN AND GAMES · 3 WEEKENDS · HARD

Every child wants a tree house. Every Bigfoot wants a tree house he can stand up in. The answer is the big oak, a lot of lumber and Woodrow lifting the beams while Father hammers. It is the finest tree house in the county and the only one with a twelve-foot ceiling.

1



Draw the Plan

On butcher paper at the kitchen table. Make the door tall.

2



Pick the Strongest Tree

The big oak. Check every branch.

3

Knock on the Trunk

Woodrow knocks on it. A good oak answers with a solid thud.



4



Lay the Floor

Thick planks, close together.

5



Hang a Rope Ladder

For the children. Woodrow just steps up.

6



Move In the Cushions

And a lantern, and a checkerboard. And Woodrow.

NOTES

Build a little shelf for his snacks. A tree house with snacks is a tree house he will stay in.

IMPORTANT

Check the floor every spring. A Bigfoot tree house takes a lot of weight.

MATERIALS

- Lumber and beams



- A hammer and nails



- A rope ladder



- A strong oak tree



- A drawing on paper



HOW TO

TEACHING HIM TO DANCE

SKILL 46 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 EVENING · MEDIUM

Woodrow heard Glenn Miller on the radio one evening and has been swaying ever since. A Bigfoot who dances is a happy Bigfoot, and a happy Bigfoot is a calm one. Roll back the rug, put on a record and start with the box step.

MATERIALS


A record player


Glenn Miller records


Clear floor space


Comfortable shoes


A good sense of rhythm

1



Roll Back the Rug

And move the lamps. All the lamps.

2



Put On a Record

Something slow. 'Moonlight Serenade'.

3



Show Him the Box Step

Forward, side, back, side. Count it out loud.

4



Let Him Lead

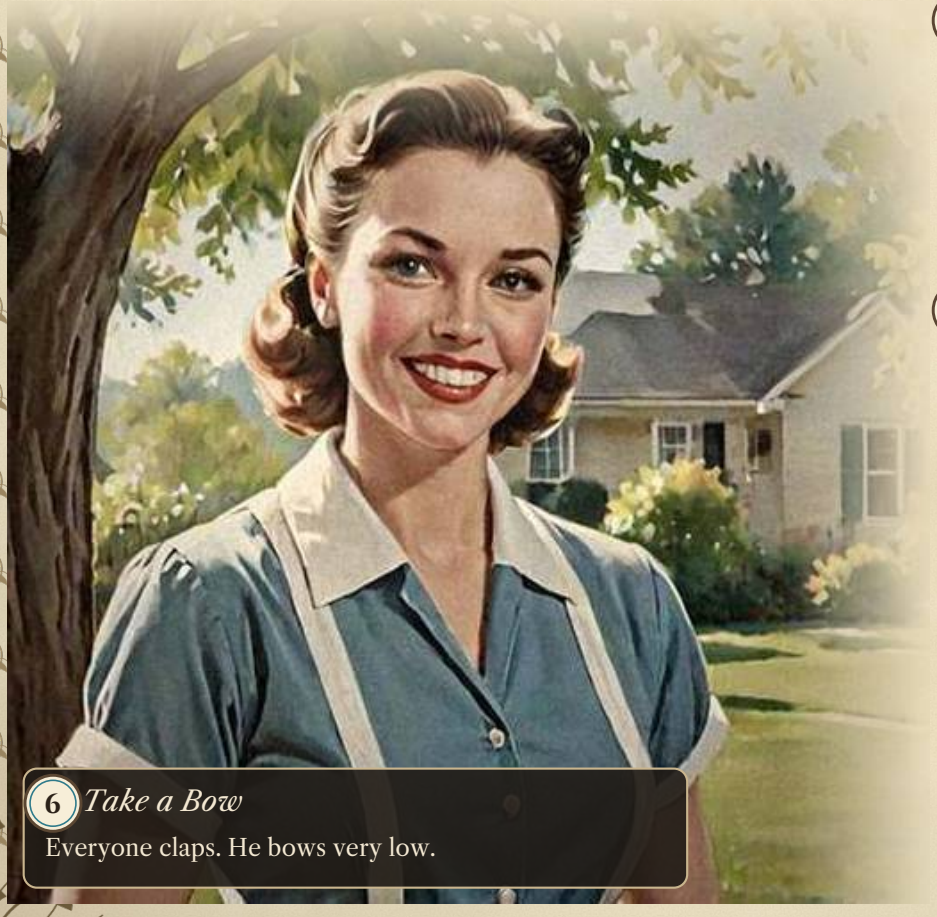
He will want to. Hold on.

5



Try a Twirl

He twirls. Then he twirls you. Then he twirls the lamp.



6 *Take a Bow*

Everyone claps. He bows very low.

NOTES

He dances best barefoot, which is lucky, because there are no shoes in his size.

IMPORTANT

Do not teach him the jitterbug. The ceiling plaster has only just been fixed.

HOW TO

ROASTING MARSHMALLOWS SAFELY

SKILL 47 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 EVENING · EASY

Woodrow is not fond of fire. Most creatures of the forest are not. But he is very fond of marshmallows, and a small campfire in a ring of stones, with Grandfather in charge, has turned him into a patient marshmallow roaster of great skill.

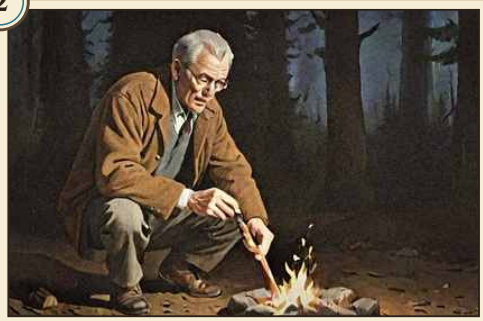
1



Build a Stone Ring

Big flat stones in a circle, well away from the house.

2



Light a Small Fire

Grandfather does this. Small is the word.

3

Keep the Water Close

A full bucket beside the fire, always.



4



Hand Out Long Sticks

Long sticks keep everyone's fur and fingers safe.

5



Roast Golden Brown

Slowly. Turn it. Patience.

6



Pour Water on the Fire

Douse, stir, douse. Every ember out.

NOTES

Sandwich the marshmallow between two graham crackers and a square of chocolate. Woodrow eats eleven.

IMPORTANT

Never let him blow on the fire. It goes out, or it goes everywhere.

MATERIALS

- A ring of stones



- Dry kindling



- Long roasting sticks



- A bag of marshmallows



- A bucket of water



HOW TO

PLAYING CHECKERS (NOT EATING THEM)

SKILL 48 · FUN AND GAMES · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Grandfather taught Woodrow to play checkers in the winter. The first week, Woodrow ate eight of the red pieces. The second week, he won. He is now the best checkers player in the county and Grandfather is looking for a new hobby.

MATERIALS


A checkerboard

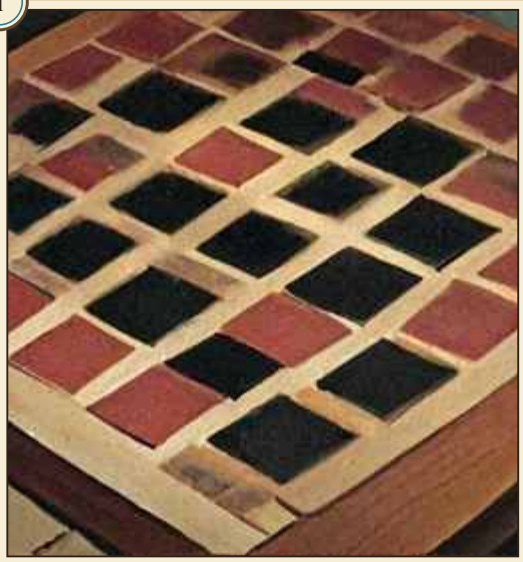

Checker pieces


A card table


Two chairs (one sturdy)


A bowl of popcorn

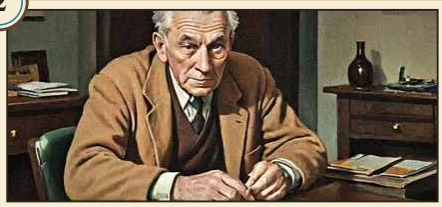
1



Set Up the Board

Red for Grandfather, black for Woodrow.

2



Explain the Moves

Forward, on the diagonal. Slowly.

3



Put the Popcorn Out

So he has something else to put in his mouth.

4



Let Him Move

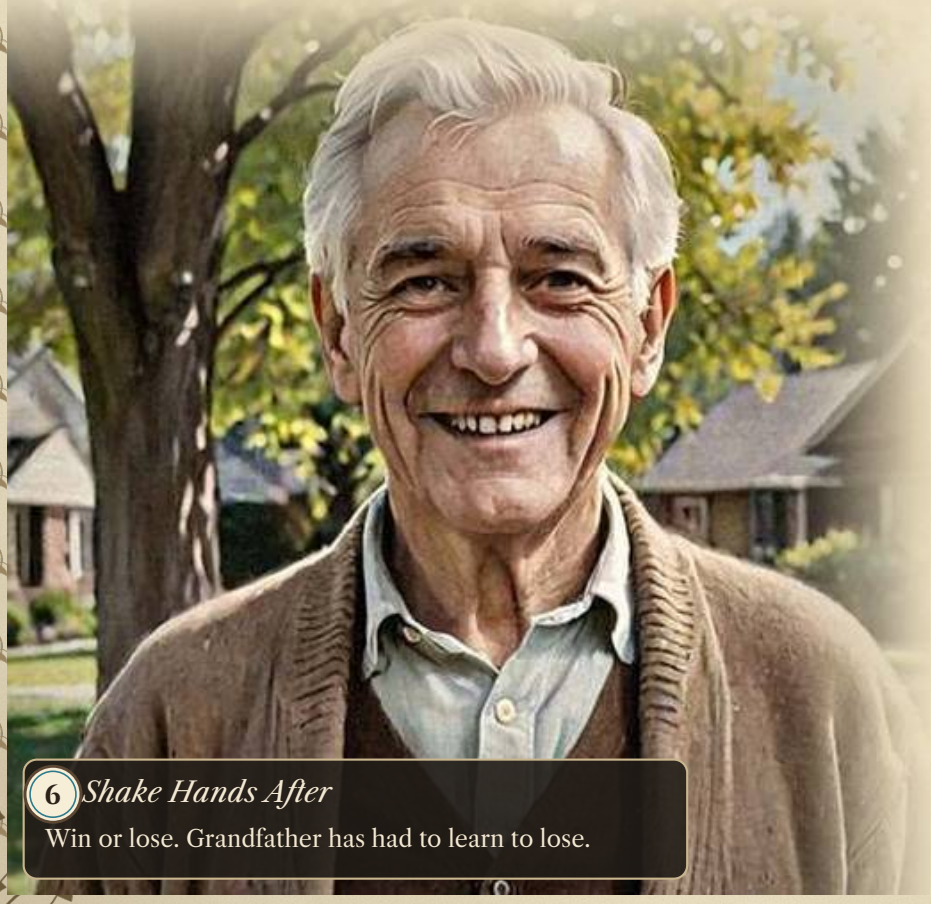
He picks each piece up very carefully.

5



King Me!

He loves crowning a king. He crowns them on his head first.



6 *Shake Hands After*

Win or lose. Grandfather has had to learn to lose.

NOTES

Try dominoes next. He is very good at building them into towers, if not at the actual game.

IMPORTANT

Count the pieces before and after. Then check the popcorn bowl.

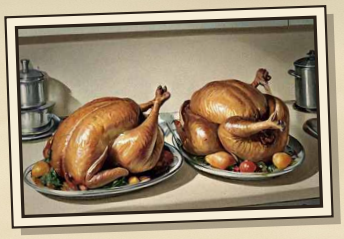
CHAPTER EIGHT

8

HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS

Halloween, Thanksgiving and his very first Christmas







Holidays are when a family is most a family. They are also when a Bigfoot is most confused. Why is there a tree in the living room? Why is the turkey not running? Why are the children dressed as ghosts? Woodrow has been through a full year of holidays now and has decided they are all wonderful, especially the pie. Here is how we made each one special.

IN THIS CHAPTER

49 His First Halloween
50 Thanksgiving Dinner for Twelve (and Him)
51 His First Christmas Tree
52 A Birthday Party for Bigfoot
53 The Family Portrait
54 Surviving the Fourth of July

HOW TO

HIS FIRST HALLOWEEN

SKILL 49 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 EVENING · EASY

MATERIALS

- A pillowcase for candy



- A jack-o'-lantern



- A flashlight



- The children's costumes



- A bowl of candy for home



On Halloween, Woodrow does not need a disguise. That is the beauty of it. He walks the whole street with the children, and every house says 'What a marvelous costume!' He has never been happier, and he came home with four pounds of candy corn.

1



Carve a Jack-o'-Lantern
He scoops out the seeds. He eats the seeds.

2



Dress the Children
Old sheets and Father's cowboy hat. Simple costumes are the best costumes.

3

No Costume for Woodrow
He goes as himself. Everybody loves it.



4



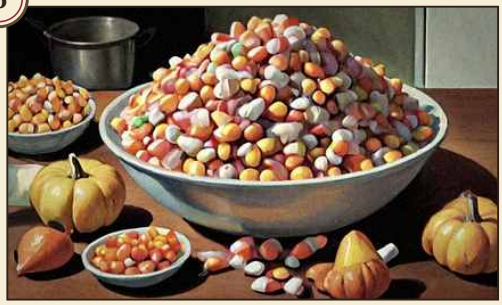
Hand Him a Pillowcase
The biggest one in the linen closet.

5



Walk the Street Together
Hold hands at the crossings.

6



Sort the Candy at Home
On the kitchen table. Trade fairly.

NOTES

Let him hand out the candy at your door for the first hour. The neighborhood talks about it for years.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him bob for apples. The tub empties in one go.

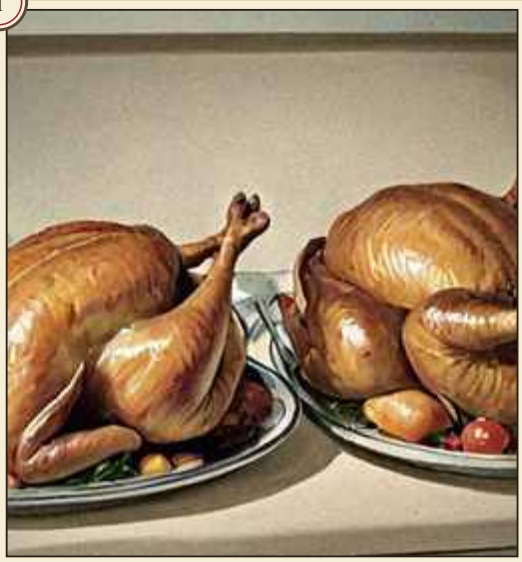
HOW TO

THANKSGIVING DINNER FOR TWELVE (AND HIM)

SKILL 50 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 DAY · HARD

Thanksgiving with a Bigfoot means two turkeys, three pies and a table extended into the hall. Woodrow is thankful for everything, loudly. He carries in the turkeys, he mashes the potatoes by hand and he eats the second turkey by himself.

1



Roast Two Turkeys

One for the family, one for Woodrow.

2



Mash by Hand

He mashes all the potatoes in one minute. Supervise.

3



Extend the Table

Every leaf. Into the hall if you must.

MATERIALS



Two turkeys



A sack of potatoes



Three pies



The table leaves



A big bib

4



Carry In the Bird

He carries it in like a crown. Let him.

5



Go Round the Table

Everyone says one thing they are thankful for. He says 'pie'.

NOTES

Save the wishbone for him. He does not understand it, but he will hold it up for an hour.

IMPORTANT

Do not leave the second turkey on the counter while you say grace.



6 *Pie for Everyone*

Pumpkin, apple and pecan. He tries all three.

HOW TO

HIS FIRST CHRISTMAS TREE

SKILL 51 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 WEEKEND · MEDIUM

MATERIALS

- A saw



- A tree stand



- Lights and ornaments



- A gold star



- A sled for the tree



Woodrow's first Christmas tree came in by the roots. He walked into the woods, pulled up a spruce and brought it home, roots, dirt and a sleeping owl. Since then, we have taught him to choose a tree, cut it neatly and leave the owls where they are.

1



Walk to the Woods
With the sled, in the snow, singing.

2



Choose a Tree Together
Not the biggest. The nicest.

3

Cut, Do Not Pull
Father saws. Woodrow holds it steady.



4



Check for Owls
And squirrels. Shake it gently.

5



Carry It Home
He carries it on one shoulder.

6



Put the Star On
He does not need a ladder.

NOTES

Let him hang the tinsel. He does it one strand at a time, with great care.

IMPORTANT

Never use glass ornaments on the bottom branches. He sniffs them.

HOW TO

A BIRTHDAY PARTY FOR BIGFOOT

SKILL 52 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

We do not know when Woodrow was born, or in what century. So we picked the day we found him and called it his birthday. He gets a cake the size of a tire, a paper crown and the whole family singing. He cries every year.

1



Bake a Big Cake

Three layers, chocolate, with a pound of frosting.

2



Hang the Balloons

Up high. He will reach them anyway.

3



Make a Paper Crown

Gold paper, glitter and a lot of glue.

MATERIALS


A three-layer cake


Candles


A paper crown


Balloons


Presents wrapped in newspaper

4



Light the Candles

Just a few. We do not know the real number.

5



Sing Together

He sways. He hums. He weeps a little.

NOTES

Give him a harmonica. He cannot play it, but he loves to blow into it, and it is the cheeriest sound in the house.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him blow out the candles from close up. The frosting will end up on the ceiling.



6 *Open the Presents*

Wrapped in newspaper. A new brush, a new quilt and a harmonica.

HOW TO

THE FAMILY PORTRAIT

SKILL 53 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 AFTERNOON · HARD

MATERIALS

- A camera on a tripod



- Sunday clothes



- A bench



- A comb



- A squirrel-free yard



Every family needs a portrait for the mantelpiece. Ours took four tries. In the first one Woodrow sneezed. In the second he was looking at a squirrel. In the third he was the only one in the frame. The fourth is on the mantelpiece and it is perfect.

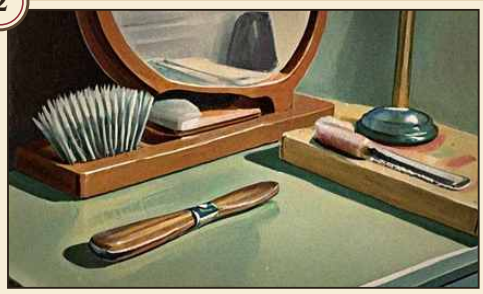
1



Dress Everyone Up

Sunday clothes. A bow tie for Woodrow.

2



Comb His Fur

Part it down the middle. He looks very respectable.

3

Set Up the Camera

On a tripod in the yard, with the timer.



4



Arrange the Family

Him in the back. Everyone else on the bench in front.

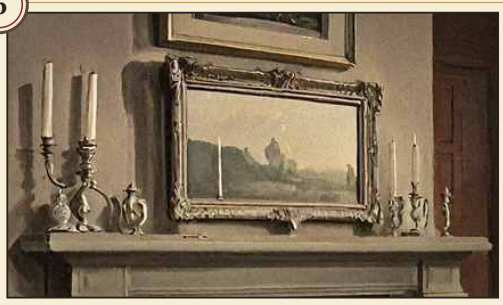
5



Say Cheese

He says 'Rrrr'. It counts.

6



Frame It

Silver frame, mantelpiece, center.

NOTES

Shoot in the late afternoon. The golden light is kind to fur.

IMPORTANT

Do not let the children make bunny ears behind his head. He cannot see them, but he will hear the giggling.

HOW TO

SURVIVING THE FOURTH OF JULY

SKILL 54 · HOLIDAYS AND SPECIAL OCCASIONS · 1 EVENING · HARD

Woodrow loves a parade, bunting and a picnic. He does not love fireworks. The first Fourth of July, he spent the whole display under the porch. We have since worked out a plan: an early picnic, a sparkler or two and a quiet spot by the lake for the big show.

1



Hang the Bunting

He can do the whole porch without a ladder.

2



Early Picnic

Fried chicken and watermelon at four o'clock.

3



Wave the Flags

Small flags for the children. A big one for Woodrow.

MATERIALS



A picnic basket



Bunting



Sparklers



Earmuffs (big ones)



A quiet spot by the lake

4



Try a Sparkler

One. Held far out. He thinks it is a star.

5



Fetch His Earmuffs

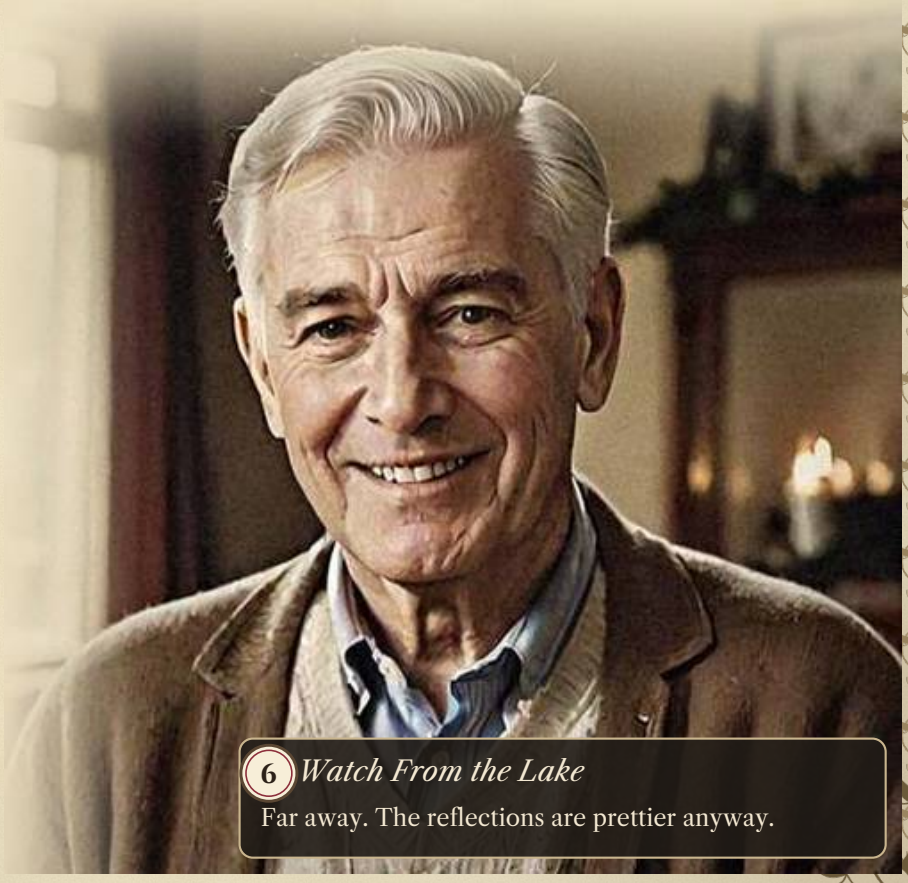
Before the big show, fetch his big woolly earmuffs from the porch.

NOTES

Sit with him during the show. A hand on his arm and a peppermint go a long way.

IMPORTANT

Never let anyone light firecrackers near the woodshed.



6 *Watch From the Lake*

Far away. The reflections are prettier anyway.

CHAPTER NINE

9

A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST

Thank-you notes, the county fair and goodnight under the stars







The aim of all good upbringing is a fellow who can go out into the world and make it a little better. Woodrow has come a long way since the morning he sneezed at us from the woodshed. He writes thank-you notes, he helps the Ranger, he won a blue ribbon at the county fair and he waves to everyone. This last chapter is about being a good citizen, of the town and of the forest.

IN THIS CHAPTER

55 Writing a Thank-You Note
56 Winning a Ribbon at the County Fair
57 Helping the Forest Ranger
58 Visiting His Relatives in the Woods
59 Waving Hello to Everyone
60 Saying Goodnight Under the Stars

HOW TO

WRITING A THANK-YOU NOTE

SKILL 55 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · 30 MINUTES · MEDIUM

Every gift deserves a thank-you note, and Woodrow receives a great many gifts. He cannot write, exactly, but he can draw, and he presses very hard. Grandmother helps him with the words. The neighbors keep his notes in their scrapbooks.

1



Get Out the Stationery

The good cream paper. It is a thank-you note.

2



Give Him a Thick Pencil

A carpenter's pencil. Ordinary ones snap.

3

Draw the Gift

He draws what he got. Very large.



4



Add the Words

Grandmother writes 'Thank you' in her best hand.

5



Seal the Envelope

He licks it. He licks all of them.

6



Walk It to the Mailbox

He likes to put up the little red flag.

NOTES

Keep a stack of notes ready after birthdays and Christmas. He likes to do them all at once.

IMPORTANT

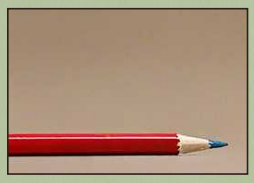
Do not let him lick the stamps. He eats them.

MATERIALS

- Nice stationery



- A thick pencil



- Envelopes



- Stamps



- Grandmother's help



HOW TO

WINNING A RIBBON AT THE COUNTY FAIR

SKILL 56 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · 1 SUMMER · HARD

Woodrow grew the biggest pumpkin in the county. He watered it, talked to it and slept beside it on hot nights. At the fair it weighed six hundred pounds, and he carried it onto the scale himself. The judges did not ask about Uncle Walter. They gave him a blue ribbon.

MATERIALS


Pumpkin seeds

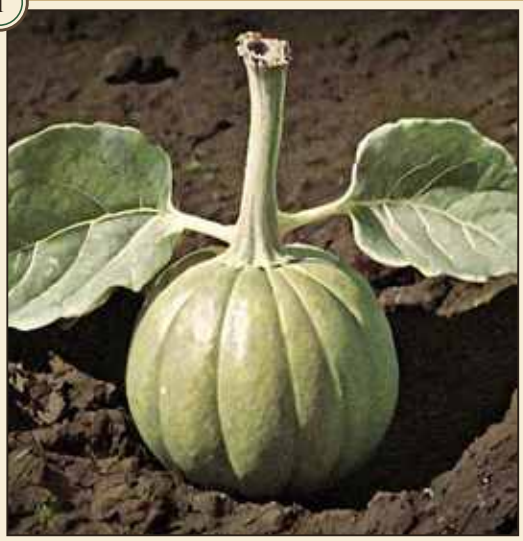

A watering can


A sunny patch


A wheelbarrow


The disguise

1



Plant in Spring

One seed, a sunny spot, a lot of manure.

2



Water Every Day

He carries the watering can. He sings to it.

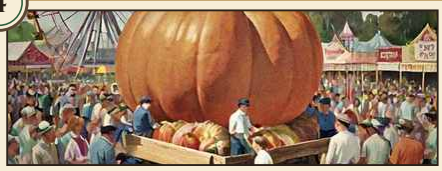
3



Watch It Grow

Measure it every Sunday.

4



Carry It to the Fair

On his back. The truck could not take it.

5



Wait for the Judges

Stand beside it in the disguise. Look humble.



6 *Win the Blue Ribbon*

Pin it on the pumpkin. Then on him.

NOTES

Plant a row of sunflowers on the north side. They shelter the pumpkin and Woodrow likes to eat the seeds.

IMPORTANT

Do not let him hug the pumpkin. He hugged his first one too hard.

HOW TO

HELPING THE FOREST RANGER

SKILL 57 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · 1 DAY · MEDIUM

Ranger Dobbs has come to rely on Woodrow. He clears fallen trees from the trails, he carries supplies to the lookout tower and he finds lost hikers by smell. In return, the Ranger keeps his secret and brings doughnuts. It is the best arrangement in the county.

1



Meet at the Trailhead
Seven o'clock, with doughnuts.

2



Clear the Fallen Trees
Woodrow lifts them off the trail.

3

Carry Supplies Up the Tower
Fifty pounds of supplies, one trip.



4



Watch for Smoke
From the tower he can see for forty miles.

5



Find a Lost Hiker
He follows his nose down the trail and brings them back, a little surprised.

6



Doughnuts at the Station
Everyone has earned one.

NOTES

Bring a spare canteen. Woodrow drinks from streams, but the Ranger does not want him to.

IMPORTANT

Hunting season is no time for helping. Keep him home in November.

MATERIALS

- Work gloves



- A trail map



- A canteen



- A first-aid kit



- Doughnuts



HOW TO

VISITING HIS RELATIVES IN THE WOODS

SKILL 58 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · 1 WEEKEND · MEDIUM

Woodrow has family too: a mother, two sisters and an uncle who lives on the mountain. Once a year he visits them, and once a year we pack him a basket. He comes back a week later with pine needles in his fur and a look of great contentment.

MATERIALS


A big picnic basket


Pies (four)


A letter of greeting


A walking stick


A map he will not use

1



Pack a Basket

Four pies, a ham and a jar of honey for his mother.

2



Write a Letter of Greeting

He cannot read it. Neither can they. It is the thought.

3



Walk Him to the Edge of the Woods

As far as the old fence. Not one step further.

4



Watch Him Go

He looks back once. He always looks back once.

5



Leave a Light On

A lantern on the woodshed, every night until he is back.



6 *Welcome Him Home*

With pancakes. Of course with pancakes.

NOTES

Put a family photograph in the basket. We think his mother keeps it.

IMPORTANT

Do not follow him. Some families are private.

HOW TO

WAVING HELLO TO EVERYONE

SKILL 59 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · EVERY DAY · EASY

A good citizen waves. Woodrow waves at the mailman, the milkman, the school bus, the cows and the airplanes. He waves with his whole arm. In a year he has turned Elm Street into the friendliest street in town, simply by waving.

1



Sit on the Porch
Mornings, when the street wakes up.

2



Wave at the Mailman
He waves back now. It took six months.

3

Wave at the School Bus
The children wave back from every window.



4



Wave at the Airplanes
He thinks they can see him. Who is to say?

5



Teach the Children
Whole arm. Big smile. Every time.

6



Count the Waves Back
Forty-two on a good day.

NOTES

Waving is free, and it is the best neighborly thing you can do. Teach every Bigfoot you meet.

IMPORTANT

Do not wave at the photographer. He will take it as an invitation.

MATERIALS

- A front porch



- A friendly face



- A whole arm



- A good morning



- Neighbors



HOW TO

SAYING GOODNIGHT UNDER THE STARS

SKILL 60 · A GOOD CITIZEN OF THE FOREST · EVERY NIGHT · EASY

Every evening, when the dishes are done and the children are in bed, Woodrow sits on the back step and looks at the stars. Mother brings two cups of cocoa. They do not say much. They do not need to. That is the last lesson of raising a well-behaved Bigfoot: he was family all along.

MATERIALS


Two cups of cocoa

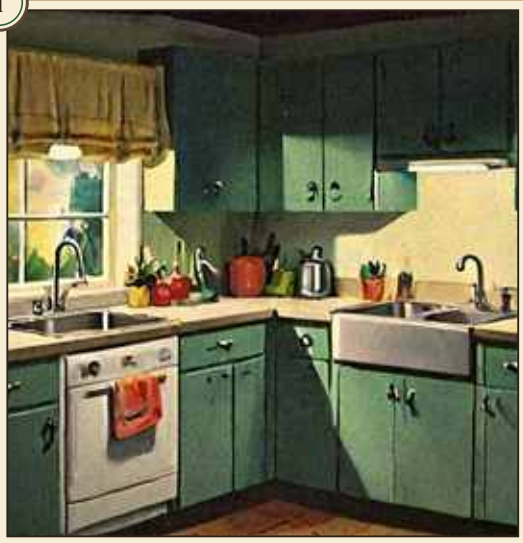

A quilt


The back step


A clear night


A quiet moment

1



Finish the Dishes
Every dish done, every light out but one.

2



Make Two Cocoas
One cup. One mixing bowl.

3



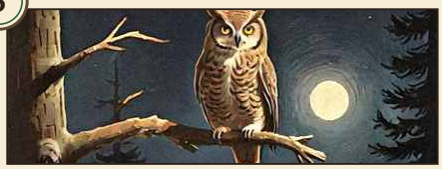
Sit on the Back Step
Side by side. Bring a quilt.

4

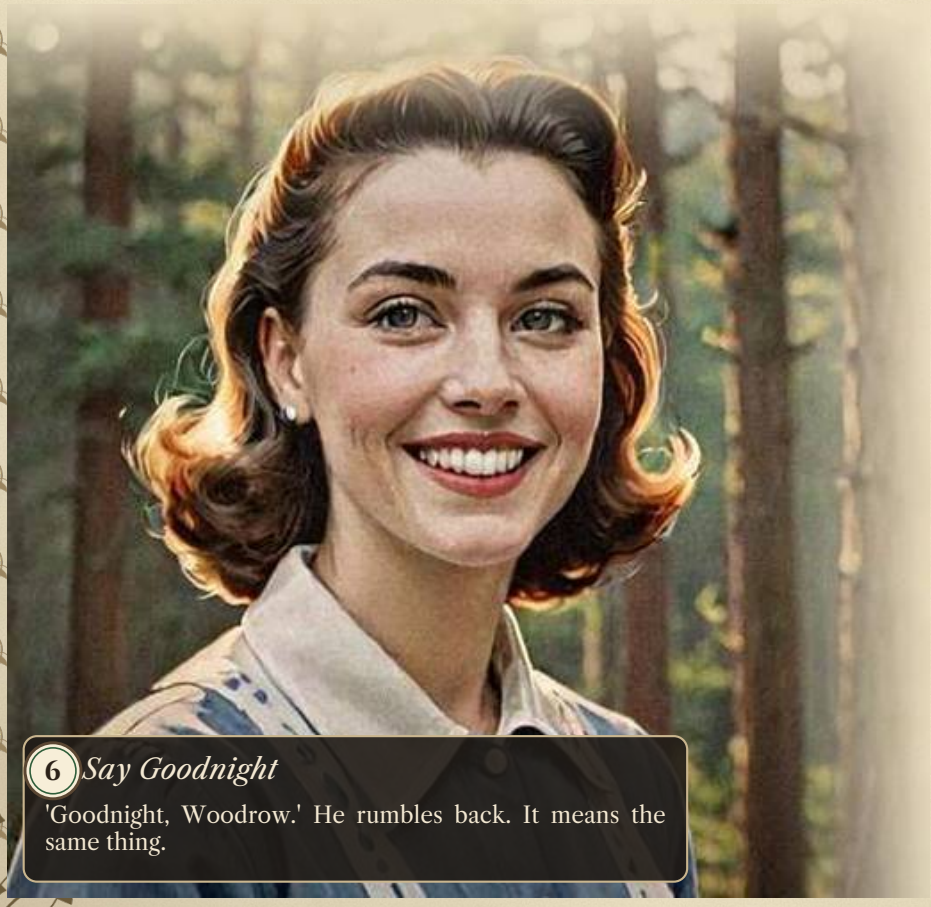


Look at the Stars
He knows them all. He points them out.

5



Listen to the Woods
The owls, the wind, the creek.



6 *Say Goodnight*
'Goodnight, Woodrow.' He rumbles back. It means the same thing.

NOTES

On the first night of every year, write down one thing he learned. The list is very long now.

IMPORTANT

Do not stay out too long in winter. Even Bigfoot catches cold, and his sneezes rattle the windows.

APPENDIX

Charts, checklists and quick references

A. FIELD GUIDE TO PINE HOLLOW

Who you are likely to meet, where to find them and how to handle them. When in doubt, offer pie.

WHO OR WHAT	WHERE FOUND	LOOKS LIKE	FOND OF	HANDLE WITH
Woodrow (Bigfoot)	The woodshed	Eight feet two, very hairy	Pancakes, low C	Kindness and pie
Uncle Walter	Main Street, Sundays	Trench coat, big hat	Nodding	Do not ask
Ranger Dobbs	The ranger station	Green uniform, flat hat	Rhubarb pie	Doughnuts
Mrs. Pruitt	Next door, over the fence	Flowered hat, opinions	Gossip, knitting	Coffee cake
Mr. Finch (Gazette)	In the hedge	Camera, bow tie	Scoops	Coffee and a blur
Gus the barber	Main Street, after six	White jacket, scissors	Rhubarb pie	Trust
Mr. Gruber	The hardware store	Apron, pencil	Regular customers	Peppermints
Reverend Peabody	First Methodist	Black robe, kind face	Attentive listeners	A gentle handshake
Woodrow's relatives	Up the mountain	Like Woodrow, shyer	Honey, pies	Distance and respect

B. THE FEEDING CHART

What he eats, how much and when. Buy pancake flour by the sack.

FOOD	HOW MUCH HE EATS	BEST SERVED	NOTES
Pancakes	48 at a sitting	Saturday morning	Buttermilk, with blueberries
Apples	A bushel a week	From his basket	Never from the neighbor's tree
Pot roast	Half of it	Sunday supper	Wait for grace
Peas	One cup (reluctantly)	With cheese sauce	Fresh in the pod is a game
Pie	Any amount	After supper	Rhubarb pays the barber
Marshmallows	Eleven s'mores	Over a small fire	Long sticks only
Pine cones	None	Never	Not a food. Remove from the table
Frozen peas	A bag	On hot days	His favorite treat

C. CHECKLISTS

Copy these pages and tick items off as you get ready. Check the doormats and the brush every week.

THE BIGFOOT WELCOME KIT

- ☐ A stack of pancakes
- ☐ A tree stump for serving
- ☐ Straw bales and quilts
- ☐ A lantern on a high nail
- ☐ Two big doormats
- ☐ A cushion for the door frame
- ☐ A sturdy oak bench
- ☐ A big yellow mixing bowl
- ☐ A striped towel bib
- ☐ A snack basket
- ☐ A horse brush
- ☐ A coal shovel

THE UNCLE WALTER DISGUISE

- ☐ Extra-large trench coat
- ☐ Wide-brimmed hat
- ☐ Big dark glasses
- ☐ Long knitted scarf
- ☐ Big galoshes
- ☐ A peppermint for emergencies
- ☐ A story about Oregon
- ☐ A practiced nod
- ☐ The station wagon, back seats down

BATH DAY IN THE YARD

- ☐ A warm sunny day
- ☐ Garden hose
- ☐ A bucket of suds
- ☐ Long-handled scrub brush
- ☐ Raincoats for everyone
- ☐ A cup of vinegar for the rinse
- ☐ Six old bedsheets
- ☐ A clothesline
- ☐ Lemonade
- ☐ A camera for the fluffy picture

D. HOUSEHOLD REMEDIES FOR BIGFOOT MISHAPS

Every Bigfoot causes a little bother sooner or later. Here is what to do, calmly and kindly.

MISHAP	REMEDY	NOTES
Bumped head in a doorway	Cushion on the frame	And a cookie
Muddy footprints indoors	Two doormats, a bucket	Then the mop
Flattened armchair	Clamps and glue	Build him a bench
On the roof again	A bag of apples	Give him the oak tree
Howling after nine	The quiet bell	And Bing Crosby
Empty icebox at 2 a.m.	A latch and a snack basket	Leave a sandwich out
Gravy in the fur	A tea towel napkin	Bath day on Saturday
Burrs and twigs	Horse brush, every evening	On the back porch
Fur on everything	Sweep, bag, give to birds	Shedding season only
Photographer in the hedge	A big umbrella	And a cup of coffee
Frightened by the vacuum	Use the broom	Look on the roof
Ate the checkers	Count them first	Check the popcorn bowl

E. HANDY BIGFOOT CONVERSIONS

MEASURE	ROUGHLY EQUALS
1 Bigfoot footprint	20 inches (1 3/4 rulers)
1 Bigfoot breakfast	48 pancakes
1 Bigfoot howl	11 miles of neighbors
1 Bigfoot sneeze	All the pins in your hair
1 Bigfoot snowball	1 beach ball
1 shedding season	6 weeks, 14 sacks of fur
1 napkin	1 tea towel
1 plate	1 big yellow mixing bowl
1 haircut	1 rhubarb pie
1 wave	1 friend on Elm Street
1 well-behaved Bigfoot	1 very happy family

F. HOUSEHOLD BIGFOOT CARD

Fill this in together and pin a copy by the telephone and inside the woodshed door.

Household name	
Your Bigfoot's name	
Date he arrived	
Footprint length	
Height (to the top of the fur)	
Pancakes per breakfast	
His chair is	
Quiet bell is kept in	
Bath day	
Disguise is kept in	
Shedding season starts	
His favorite song	

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
The doctor	
Father's office	
Grandmother	
Mrs. Pruitt (next door)	
First Methodist (the Reverend)	
Ranger Dobbs	
Gus the barber (after six)	

G. GLOSSARY

Bigfoot. A large, shy, hairy fellow of the northern woods. Also called Sasquatch. Ours is called Woodrow.

Box step. The first dance step. Forward, side, back, side. Move the lamps first.

Burr. A prickly seed that rides home in fur. Brush daily.

Doormat (Bigfoot size). Two doormats.

Footprint. A letter of introduction that has not been opened yet.

Galoshes. Rubber overshoes. They hide the feet, which are always the giveaway.

Howl. A Bigfoot's way of saying good night. Carries eleven miles.

Icebox. The refrigerator. Needs a latch.

Indoor voice. A hum. A howl with its manners on.

Lookout tower. A tall wooden tower where the Ranger watches for smoke. Woodrow carries up the supplies.

Low C. Woodrow's favorite piano note.

Napkin. A tea towel, for him.

Quiet bell. A little brass bell. One ding means softer.

Sasquatch. Another name for Bigfoot. Sounds fancier at church.

Shedding season. Six weeks in spring when there is fur in the butter.

Uncle Walter. Woodrow, in a trench coat. From Oregon. Has a condition.

Woodshed. Woodrow's bedroom. Knock first.

Woodrow. Our Bigfoot. Eight feet two, very hairy and very well behaved.

H. WHERE TO LEARN MORE

- **Manners:** your public library has excellent etiquette books. They do not mention Bigfoot, but the principles hold.
- **The forest:** your local forest ranger, who knows where the berries grow and where the hunters walk.
- **Cookery:** Mother's recipe box, the church cookbook and Grandmother, who can make pancakes for forty-eight.
- **Real wildlife:** admire it from a distance and never feed it. Listen to the Ranger first, and to this book second.
- **Good neighbors:** the folks next door. Take them a coffee cake.

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MY SKILLS LOG

Tick off each skill once your household has done it. Do not let Woodrow tick them. He presses too hard and goes through the page.

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
01	Reading Footprints in the Snow		☐
02	Leaving Out a Plate of Pancakes		☐
03	Making a Proper Introduction		☐
04	Choosing a Good Name		☐
05	Fixing Up the Woodshed as a Bedroom		☐
06	Explaining Things to the Neighbors		☐
07	Dealing With the Forest Ranger		☐
08	Ducking Through Doorways		☐
09	Wiping His Feet (All Twenty Inches)		☐
10	Sitting on Furniture That Will Hold Him		☐
11	Keeping Him Off the Roof		☐
12	Using His Indoor Voice		☐
13	Keeping Him Out of the Icebox		☐
14	Bedtime and the Big Blanket		☐
15	Setting a Place for a Sasquatch		☐
16	Using a Napkin Instead of His Arm		☐
17	Flipping Pancakes by the Dozen		☐
18	Saying Grace and Waiting His Turn		☐
19	Eating His Vegetables (Not the Centerpiece)		☐
20	Passing the Potatoes Politely		☐
21	Helping With the Dishes		☐
22	Brushing Out the Burrs		☐
23	Bath Day With the Garden Hose		☐
24	Drying a Very Wet Bigfoot		☐
25	Trimming His Toenails		☐
26	Brushing His Big Teeth		☐
27	Dealing With the Forest Smell		☐
28	Surviving the Shedding Season		☐
29	Taking Him for a Drive		☐
30	Disguising Him as Uncle Walter		☐
31	A Trip to the Hardware Store		☐
32	Walking Down Main Street		☐
33	Visiting the Barbershop		☐
34	Sitting in the Back Pew at Church		☐
35	Dodging the Newspaper Photographer		☐
36	Splitting the Winter Firewood		☐
37	Carrying the Groceries in One Trip		☐

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
38	Raking the Autumn Leaves		☐
39	Shoveling the Snow		☐
40	Reaching the High Shelves		☐
41	Moving the Piano		☐
42	Teaching Him to Play Catch		☐
43	Playing Hide-and-Seek (He Loses)		☐
44	Camping Out in the Backyard		☐
45	Building a Tree House Big Enough		☐
46	Teaching Him to Dance		☐
47	Roasting Marshmallows Safely		☐
48	Playing Checkers (Not Eating Them)		☐
49	His First Halloween		☐
50	Thanksgiving Dinner for Twelve (and Him)		☐
51	His First Christmas Tree		☐
52	A Birthday Party for Bigfoot		☐
53	The Family Portrait		☐
54	Surviving the Fourth of July		☐
55	Writing a Thank-You Note		☐
56	Winning a Ribbon at the County Fair		☐
57	Helping the Forest Ranger		☐
58	Visiting His Relatives in the Woods		☐
59	Waving Hello to Everyone		☐
60	Saying Goodnight Under the Stars		☐

NOTES

Pancakes flipped, doorways ducked, burrs brushed and every howl forgiven.

THE BOOK EVERY SENSIBLE FAMILY NEEDS

It started with the footprints. Twenty inches long, out of the pine woods and straight across the lawn to the woodshed. Then the woodshed door opened, and something eight feet tall and very hairy looked out at us and sneezed. His name is Woodrow. He eats forty-eight pancakes at a sitting, howls at the moon and is terrified of the vacuum cleaner. Somebody had better teach him some manners.

How to Raise a Well-Behaved Bigfoot is here to help: sixty wholesome skills, each laid out on a single page with a picture for every step, a materials panel and notes on what can go wrong. House rules, table manners, bath day in the yard and trips to town in disguise. Tabs on every page help you find what you need, even during shedding season.

INSIDE YOU WILL LEARN HOW TO

- Teach a Bigfoot to duck through doors
- Flip forty-eight pancakes before breakfast
- Bathe him in the yard with a garden hose
- Disguise him as Uncle Walter
- Keep him off the roof (mostly)
- Trim his toenails with garden shears
- Dodge the newspaper photographer
- Win a blue ribbon at the county fair
- Build a tree house big enough
- Say goodnight under the stars



"A footprint is just a letter of introduction."

MOTHER, THE FIRST MORNING

HOW TO RAISE A WELL-BEHAVED BIGFOOT

Family / Manners / Humor

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION